

STRATEGY / CREATIVE WORK / MEASURABLE OUTCOMES

Marketing English

Build a sharper brief. Defend the evidence. Make the message work.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For brand, content, growth, campaign, and marketing-operations professionals.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Move from audience insight to a credible message, coordinated delivery, and an accurate performance conversation.

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Persuasive does not mean imprecise.

Marketing conversations move between creative possibility and commercial accountability. You may need to challenge a favorite headline, translate a dashboard, or stop a scheduled post. These cases give you the facts and language to stay constructive while making the limits unmistakable.

Name the decision

A channel list is not an audience strategy, and a launch date is not an approved brief. Identify the decision the meeting must produce before debating execution.

"Are we deciding whom to reach, what to promise, or which version to release?"

Keep the comparison attached

Words such as faster, higher, and better need a comparison and a measurement basis. Removing the qualifier can change the meaning of the claim.

"The test compared this version with our previous version, not with competitors."

Give feedback a usable object

Describe the audience need, wording, evidence, or delivery requirement that needs revision. Separate a personal preference from a condition for approval.

"The opening promises instructions, but the body only announces a product."

Separate credit from cause

Reporting systems assign credit under rules. A rise after a campaign change is an observation; a defensible causal conclusion needs more than timing.

"The campaign and the discount changed together, so this report cannot isolate their effects."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

Fictional English-language practice, not legal advice or a promise of campaign results. Legal requirements, platform policies, and data permissions depend on context and location. Obtain current qualified review for actual claims, audience data, disclosures, and publication decisions.

The scheduling tool with an audience of everyone

A Read the situation

Narrow an audience brief while distinguishing the daily user, purchasing role, and evidence of need.

A scheduling-software brief names the audience as "everyone who works in an office." Six exploratory interviews with operations coordinators at small agencies describe repeated calendar checking. No research with purchasing managers has been completed. The proposed campaign invites coordinators to book a workflow demonstration. A draft slide calls those six interviews proof of market-wide demand. Strategist Mira and product marketer Owen must revise the brief without inventing buyer research or promising that a demonstration request will become a sale.

PEOPLE / Mira: Marketing strategist | Owen: Product marketer

CHALLENGE THE SCOPE WITHOUT DISMISSING THE AMBITION

A broad ambition can coexist with a focused first campaign. Use "for this campaign" to narrow the decision rather than imply that no other customer matters. Asking whose problem the message solves is more productive than labeling the brief vague and stopping there.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Who was actually interviewed?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Six operations coordinators at small agencies | B Six purchasing managers at large companies |
| C All office workers using scheduling software | D Six coordinators and their purchasing managers |

2. What does the proposed campaign ask people to do?

- | | |
|--|--------------------------------------|
| A Book a workflow demonstration | B Approve a purchase contract |
| C Complete a paid migration | D Submit a procurement policy |

3. Which conclusion exceeds the evidence?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A The interviews prove market-wide demand | B The interviews suggest a calendar-checking problem |
| C Buyer research remains incomplete | D A focused audience needs a clearer brief |

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

target audience

The people a particular communication is intended to reach.

IN USE define the target audience

market segment

A group distinguished by relevant shared needs or characteristics.

IN USE prioritize a market segment

ideal customer profile

A description of organizations or customers considered a strong fit.

IN USE refine the ideal customer profile

buyer persona

A research-informed representation of a purchasing role.

IN USE validate a buyer persona

end user

The person who uses the product in practice.

IN USE interview the end user

economic buyer

The role controlling the relevant purchasing budget.

IN USE identify the economic buyer

buying committee

The group influencing or deciding an organizational purchase.

IN USE map the buying committee

pain point

A specific problem the audience experiences.

IN USE substantiate a pain point

customer insight

An interpretation that explains a meaningful customer pattern.

IN USE develop a customer insight

jobs to be done

A framework focused on the progress people seek in a situation.

IN USE frame the job to be done

use case

A concrete situation in which a product serves a need.

IN USE define the primary use case

value proposition

The relevant benefit and reason to choose an offering.

IN USE sharpen the value proposition

Precision check

An audience is not necessarily the buyer, and the buyer is not necessarily the person using the product daily. "Coordinators report repeated calendar checking" preserves the actual sample. "Office workers demand our product" changes both the population and the strength of the finding.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

demand signal

Evidence suggesting interest or need, with limits.

IN USE evaluate a demand signal

qualitative research

Research examining experiences and meaning rather than only numerical estimates.

IN USE synthesize qualitative research

sample bias

Distortion arising from who is included in a sample.

IN USE acknowledge sample bias

purchase trigger

An event or condition prompting buying consideration.

IN USE identify a purchase trigger

decision criterion

A factor used to compare possible purchases.

IN USE clarify the decision criteria

barrier to adoption

A condition that makes initial or continued use harder.

IN USE investigate a barrier to adoption

addressable market

The market that could be served under a specified definition.

IN USE define the addressable market

penetration

Adoption or participation relative to a defined market base.

IN USE estimate market penetration

campaign objective

The particular outcome a campaign is intended to achieve.

IN USE agree the campaign objective

conversion action

The defined behavior counted as a conversion.

IN USE specify the conversion action

leading indicator

A measure that may precede a later outcome.

IN USE monitor a leading indicator

research hypothesis

A testable proposition that still requires evidence.

IN USE state a research hypothesis

Precision check

An insight interprets evidence; a hypothesis proposes something to test. Neither word makes a small sample representative. A demonstration request can be a conversion action for this campaign while remaining only a possible step toward revenue.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NARROW THE DECISION

"For this campaign, which role are we trying to reach first?"

SEPARATE THE ROLES

"The daily user may not control the purchasing budget."

NAME THE PROBLEM

"Repeated calendar checking is the reported friction."

REQUEST MISSING EVIDENCE

"We still need to understand the purchasing manager's criteria."

PRESERVE THE RESEARCH

"The interviews involved six coordinators, not the entire office market."

DEFINE THE ACTION

"We want qualified coordinators to book a workflow demonstration."

LIMIT THE INFERENCE

"That is an exploratory signal, not proof of market-wide demand."

CLOSE WITH SCOPE

"Let us revise the audience, evidence statement, and conversion action."

For this campaign

This phrase narrows a current decision without making a universal market claim.

Suggest versus prove

Suggest allows a bounded inference; prove claims much stronger support.

Audience and buyer

These labels name different roles even when one person fills both.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

TEST THE PREMISE

"We should label the buyer assumption as a hypothesis."

AVOID A FALSE TRADE-OFF

"A focused first campaign does not rule out other segments later."

CHECK THE WORDING

"Does the slide distinguish what people said from our interpretation?"

SEPARATE OUTCOMES

"A demonstration request is not the same as a completed sale."

CLARIFY THE BENEFIT

"Which part of the current workflow would the demonstration address?"

DEFINE QUALIFICATION

"We need an agreed meaning of qualified before reporting those requests."

LOCATE THE BARRIER

"What prevents the user from trying the workflow?"

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"We have a useful starting point, with buyer research still open."

Qualified

State the criteria rather than treating the adjective as self-explanatory.

Reported friction

Reported attributes the problem to the research participants.

From request to sale

Naming both stages avoids treating an early action as final commercial success.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which revision preserves the research correctly?

- A** Purchasing managers confirmed calendar checking as their main criterion.
- B** The interviews established the total addressable market.
- C** Six interviewed coordinators described repeated calendar checking.
- D** Office workers consistently demand a scheduling purchase.

2. Which question distinguishes use from purchasing authority?

- A** Who uses the tool, and who controls the purchasing budget?
- B** Which coordinator reported the most frequent calendar checks?
- C** Which demonstration format received the most requests?
- D** Which channel reaches the largest number of agency staff?

3. Which label fits the immediate campaign action?

- A** A verified long-term retention outcome
- B** A completed implementation
- C** A booked workflow demonstration
- D** An executed purchase agreement

4. Which response challenges the overclaim constructively?

- A** Replace the sample size with a larger target market estimate.
- B** Keep the insight, narrow its scope, and label the buyer assumption for research.
- C** Delete the research because six interviews have no use.
- D** Retain the claim until a purchasing manager objects.

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The scheduling tool with an audience of everyone

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

end user / conversion action / demand signal / target audience / research hypothesis / market segment / value proposition / leading indicator / pain point / buyer persona

- 01 **Mira:** The brief says everyone who works in an office. I understand the ambition, but which person should recognize their own problem in the first campaign?
- 02 **Owen:** The clearest ¹ _____ is operations coordinators at small agencies. Six interviews described repeated calendar checking when colleagues tried to find a meeting time.
- 03 **Mira:** That gives us a starting point. Did those same people approve software purchases, or were they describing how they would use the product?
- 04 **Owen:** They spoke as the ² _____. We have not interviewed purchasing managers, so I cannot claim that the interviews establish who controls the budget.
- 05 **Mira:** Then the slide saying we have proved market-wide demand goes further than the research. Could we keep the finding but change its scope?
- 06 **Owen:** Yes. We have an exploratory ³ _____, not a market estimate. I will keep the sample description next to the finding in the revised brief.
- 07 **Mira:** What are the coordinators actually struggling with? Give the creative team a concrete moment to show, not just the word scheduling.
- 08 **Owen:** The reported ⁴ _____ is repeated calendar checking. We should demonstrate that workflow rather than promise to remove every administrative burden across an agency.
- 09 **Mira:** Good. What would we ask the coordinator to do after seeing the message? We need something more precise than engage with the brand.
- 10 **Owen:** Book a workflow demonstration. That is the proposed ⁵ _____, but we still need agreed qualification criteria before calling every request a qualified opportunity.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Mira:** A demonstration may interest the user without answering the purchasing manager's questions. We should avoid building that missing research into a confident buyer story.
- 12 **Owen:** Agreed. Our ⁶ _____ remains incomplete. We can list the questions for research, but we should not invent purchasing priorities to make the brief look finished.
- 13 **Mira:** I expect someone will say the narrower audience limits growth. How can we explain this choice without suggesting that larger organizations will never matter?
- 14 **Owen:** Call it the initial ⁷ _____. It is a focused campaign choice based on the evidence available, not a permanent boundary around the entire business.
- 15 **Mira:** The creative team also wants a single sentence describing why this matters. Can that connect the workflow problem with a relevant product benefit?
- 16 **Owen:** Yes, but the ⁸ _____ should stay within demonstrated capabilities. A numerical time-saving claim would need its own evidence before we add it to the message.
- 17 **Mira:** And when the first requests arrive, we should not present the count as proof that the revenue target has already been reached.
- 18 **Owen:** Correct. It can serve as a ⁹ _____. We would still need to follow the requests through qualification and the actual purchasing process.
- 19 **Mira:** I will narrow the brief and change the call to action to a demonstration request. Send me the unanswered purchasing questions for the research brief.
- 20 **Owen:** I will label each unsupported buyer assumption as a ¹⁰ _____. That gives the next research round a clear purpose without weakening the evidence we already have.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. target audience | 2. end user | 3. demand signal | 4. pain point | 5. conversion action | 6. buyer persona | 7. market segment | 8. value proposition | 9. leading indicator | 10. research hypothesis

The user is not the purchaser

F Say it

A workplace-learning product is used by employees, but the learning director approves the purchase. A campaign invites employees to try a sample lesson; no company contract has been signed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

contract / users / decision / action

Strategist: "Employees are the daily ¹ _____."

Marketer: "The learning director controls the purchasing ² _____."

Strategist: "Trying a sample is the campaign's immediate ³ _____."

Marketer: "We must not report that trial as a signed ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. users | 2. decision | 3. action | 4. contract

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected audience discussion. Preserve six coordinator interviews as exploratory evidence and distinguish the daily user from the purchasing role.
2. Switch roles. Stress the proposed demo-booking action and the buyer research still missing; keep a demonstration request separate from a sale.
3. Read the corrected transfer twice. Keep employees as users and the learning director as purchase approver.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A headline that outruns its evidence

A Read the situation

Negotiate a compelling comparative message without extending the comparison beyond the test.

A draft headline calls a scheduling tool "the fastest tool on the market." The only evidence is an internal test in which the current version completed one defined calendar-import task in 40 seconds; the previous version took 50 seconds under the same stated conditions. No competitors were tested, and no independent validation has occurred. Brand lead Tessa and product marketer Arun must revise the headline and its supporting explanation before the reviewer can assess the complete advertisement.

PEOPLE / Tessa: Brand lead | Arun: Product marketer

DEFEND THE PROPOSITION, NOT A FAVORITE ADJECTIVE

Creative review can feel personal when a team has invested in a line. Acknowledge the intended effect, name the evidence problem, and propose a narrower proposition. This keeps the discussion about the communication task rather than the writer's ability or enthusiasm.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What was the actual comparator?

A Every competing scheduling tool

C The average customer's full working day

B An independently ranked market leader

D The previous version of the same product

2. What time reduction does the supplied test show?

A 50 seconds, or 100% of the previous 50 seconds

C 10 seconds, or 25% of the previous 50 seconds

B 10 seconds, or 20% of the previous 50 seconds

D 40 seconds, or 80% of the previous 50 seconds

3. Which statement is unsupported?

A No competitor testing is supplied

C The recorded task took 40 seconds in the current version

B The product is the fastest on the market

D The previous version took 50 seconds in the test

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

positioning

How an offering is framed relative to audience needs and alternatives.

IN USE clarify the positioning

message hierarchy

The order of importance assigned to communication points.

IN USE build a message hierarchy

headline

The main line introducing an advertisement or article.

IN USE revise the headline

supporting copy

Text developing or qualifying the main message.

IN USE align the supporting copy

proof point

Specific evidence supporting a proposition.

IN USE attach a proof point

substantiation

Evidence that supports an objective advertising claim.

IN USE review claim substantiation

comparative claim

A statement comparing an offering with something else.

IN USE qualify a comparative claim

superlative

A strongest-ranking expression such as fastest or largest.

IN USE challenge an unsupported superlative

comparator

The product, group, or baseline used for comparison.

IN USE identify the comparator

test conditions

The circumstances under which a test was conducted.

IN USE disclose relevant test conditions

benchmark

A reference measure or defined test for comparison.

IN USE document the benchmark

claim scope

The range of circumstances a claim purports to cover.

IN USE narrow the claim scope

Precision check

Time falls 20%: $(50 - 40) / 50$. The reciprocal task rate rises 25%: $(50 / 40) - 1$. State the measured quantity, task, comparator and conditions rather than using ambiguous faster wording. Neither calculation establishes a market ranking or every customer workflow.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

qualifier

Wording that limits or specifies a statement's meaning.

IN USE retain the necessary qualifier

net impression

The overall message an audience takes from an advertisement.

IN USE review the net impression

brand voice

The relatively consistent verbal personality of a brand.

IN USE preserve the brand voice

tone

The attitude expressed in a specific communication.

IN USE adjust the tone

reason to believe

Support that makes a promised benefit credible.

IN USE supply a reason to believe

differentiator

A relevant feature or benefit distinguishing an offering.

IN USE substantiate the differentiator

benefit statement

Wording describing a useful outcome for the audience.

IN USE sharpen the benefit statement

feature claim

A statement about a product's capability or characteristic.

IN USE verify a feature claim

message architecture

An organized structure of core and supporting messages.

IN USE maintain the message architecture

creative territory

A broad conceptual direction for creative work.

IN USE explore a creative territory

copy review

Assessment of wording and its implications before use.

IN USE complete the copy review

approval status

The recorded state of an item's review and authorization.

IN USE confirm the approval status

Precision check

A footnote does not automatically repair a headline that gives the wrong overall impression. The complete advertisement needs review. A marketer can prepare a narrower candidate statement without claiming that the reviewer has already approved it.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

RECOGNIZE THE AIM

"The line creates energy, but its comparison is broader than the test."

BOUND THE RESULT

"The task took 40 seconds rather than 50 in this internal test."

REJECT THE EXTENSION

"We have no competitor evidence for a market-wide ranking."

PRESERVE THE CONTEXT

"Keep the task and conditions with the claim."

NAME THE COMPARATOR

"We tested the current version against our previous version."

STATE THE CALCULATION

"That is a 20% reduction in the measured task time."

OFFER A REVISION

"Let us build the message around the specific tested improvement."

CLOSE WITH REVIEW

"The complete revised advertisement still needs approval."

Compared with

This expression should identify the actual reference, not leave a reader to assume competitors.

By and to

Time fell by 10 seconds, to 40 seconds; these prepositions encode different values.

Percent and seconds

Give the original basis when converting an absolute change to a percentage.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE STYLE AND FACT

"We can keep a confident tone without adding an unsupported superlative."

AVOID SHORTHAND

"I would say reduced task time, not simply faster everywhere."

MARK THE VERSION

"Please attach the exact tested build and test record."

CLARIFY AUTHORITY

"This is proposed wording, not final clearance."

CHECK THE IMPRESSION

"Would a reader infer a broader performance promise?"

NAME THE EVIDENCE GAP

"Independent validation is not part of the supplied evidence."

PROTECT THE BENEFIT

"The useful story is the improvement in this defined workflow."

REQUEST A DECISION

"Can we agree the proposition before polishing the headline?"

Confident tone

Verbal confidence does not require a universal factual claim.

Proposed wording

Proposed preserves the distinction between a candidate and an approved advertisement.

Overall impression

Review how headline, image, and qualifiers work together, not just isolated sentences.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which claim most closely matches the supplied measurement?

- A** The current version is independently verified as fastest.
- B** The defined task took 20% less time than in the previous version under the test conditions.
- C** The product saves every user 20% of their working time.
- D** The product is 20% quicker than all competing tools.

2. Which sentence uses by and to accurately?

- A** Task time fell to 10 seconds from 40 seconds.
- B** Task time fell by 20 seconds to 50 seconds.
- C** Task time fell by 10 seconds to 40 seconds.
- D** Task time fell by 40 seconds to 10 seconds.

3. What does the proposed revised wording still require?

- A** Only a footnote naming the previous product version
- B** Only the creative team's agreement on the tone
- C** Review of the complete advertisement and supporting evidence
- D** Only confirmation that ten divided by fifty equals twenty percent

4. Which feedback is most useful?

- A** Keep the superlative and explain it only after publication.
- B** Describe the internal test as independent to improve trust.
- C** Preserve the benefit, but narrow the comparator and task scope.
- D** Remove all benefits because comparison is impossible.

Answers and explanations: [page 87](#).

A headline that outruns its evidence

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approval status / claim scope / net impression / comparator / proof point / brand voice / benchmark / substantiation / supporting copy / qualifier

- 01 **Tessa:** The creative team likes the fastest tool on the market. It is short and energetic, but I want to check exactly what supports it.
- 02 **Arun:** The available ¹ _____ is our previous version. We tested one calendar-import task, and we have not tested competing tools or obtained independent validation.
- 03 **Tessa:** So fastest on the market suggests a ranking we have not established. What numbers can we actually put behind a narrower statement?
- 04 **Arun:** The ² _____ recorded fifty seconds for the previous version and forty for the current one under the same stated conditions. The difference is ten seconds.
- 05 **Tessa:** That is twenty percent less task time, using fifty as the original base. I would avoid saying customers save twenty percent of their day.
- 06 **Arun:** Right. The ³ _____ should cover that task and comparison. It does not cover every workflow, every customer, or every configuration in which the product might run.
- 07 **Tessa:** Could the headline simply say twenty percent faster and leave the explanation underneath? I am concerned that we are losing the useful benefit.
- 08 **Arun:** I would retain the measurement in the ⁴ _____ and develop a headline that does not change it. Less time for this task is clearer than an unqualified speed promise.
- 09 **Tessa:** The team may suggest putting a small asterisk after fastest. Would that solve the problem if the footnote names our previous version?
- 10 **Arun:** Not automatically. The ⁵ _____ could still be a market-wide ranking. We need the reviewer to assess the whole advertisement, rather than assume an asterisk fixes the headline.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Tessa:** I accept that fastest on the market goes too far. Can we give the writer a sharper direction than simply adding another footnote?
- 12 **Arun:** We can preserve the ⁶ _____. The confidence can come from a specific improvement and clear evidence, without the unsupported claim that no competitor is quicker.
- 13 **Tessa:** Then let us agree the proposition first: the new version reduced the measured calendar-import time compared with our old version in this test.
- 14 **Arun:** That gives us a concrete ⁷ _____. I will attach the test record so the reviewer can check the exact task, build, and conditions behind the wording.
- 15 **Tessa:** Can we call the result independently verified once the reviewer checks the copy, or would that imply a different kind of testing?
- 16 **Arun:** It would imply evidence we do not have. Internal copy approval does not become independent ⁸ _____ of the test result. We should describe the evidence as internal.
- 17 **Tessa:** I will ask for two tighter headline options around that proposition. Neither should suggest a universal benefit or comparison with the entire market.
- 18 **Arun:** And each necessary ⁹ _____ must stay visible where it matters. Otherwise the shorter version may communicate something different from the result we actually measured.
- 19 **Tessa:** I will ask for two new headlines and a complete mock-up. Keep the current version out of the release folder until the reviewer has seen it.
- 20 **Arun:** Exactly. I will mark its ¹⁰ _____ as pending and keep the evidence attached. We should not release a fragment just because we agreed on the direction today.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. comparator | 2. benchmark | 3. claim scope | 4. supporting copy | 5. net impression | 6. brand voice | 7. proof point | 8. substantiation | 9. qualifier | 10. approval status

A larger sample, not a wider claim

F Say it

A packaging team tests one box design with 80 participants. Sixty choose it over the old design. No competing brands appear, and the sample is not established as representative.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

sample / comparator / leadership / seventy-five

Researcher: "Sixty out of eighty is ¹ _____ percent."

Marketer: "The ² _____ was our old design."

Researcher: "Keep the participant ³ _____ attached to the result."

Marketer: "We cannot call this proof of market ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. seventy-five | 2. comparator | 3. sample | 4. leadership

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected claim review. State 50 seconds down to 40, ten seconds less and a 20% time reduction against the previous version.
2. Switch roles. Keep the internal task test distinct from independent validation and competitor ranking; retain the need to review the full advertisement.
3. Read the corrected transfer. Report 60 of 80 participants as 75% without converting design preference into market leadership.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A launch date without a launch-ready brief

A Read the situation

Resolve ownership and release dependencies while separating a target date from authorization.

A campaign is targeted for Monday. The calendar lists email, paid social, and a landing page, but the audience, approved message, and success measure are missing from the shared brief. Designer Ben has prepared a layout with placeholder copy. Campaign manager Priya owns the brief; the product lead owns message approval, and the operations lead owns tracking checks. No paid placement is booked. Priya and Ben must agree the sequence and handoff conditions without presenting Monday as an unconditional release commitment.

PEOPLE / Priya: Campaign manager | Ben: Designer

A BLOCKER NEEDS AN OWNER AND AN EFFECT

Saying "we are not aligned" leaves colleagues unsure what to do. Name the missing input, its owner, and the work it prevents. You can protect another team's time by explaining which preparation may continue and which deliverable is not yet ready for approval.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Who owns the shared brief?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Priya, the campaign manager | B Ben, because he prepared the layout |
| C The operations lead, because tracking is required | D Every channel owner with no single accountable person |

2. Which work has actually been prepared?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A A layout containing placeholder copy | B A fully approved landing page |
| C A booked paid-media placement | D A final measurement report |

3. How should Monday be described?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A The final performance-reporting deadline | B A target date subject to unresolved release conditions |
| C An unconditional public commitment | D The date all reviewers have already approved |

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

go-to-market plan

A coordinated plan for bringing an offering to its intended market.

IN USE align the go-to-market plan

campaign brief

A shared statement of audience, objective, message, and delivery requirements.

IN USE complete the campaign brief

deliverable

A specified output that a person or team must supply.

IN USE define the deliverable

dependency

Something that must be available for another task to proceed.

IN USE resolve a dependency

critical path

The sequence of dependent tasks that determines earliest completion.

IN USE identify the critical path

workback schedule

A timeline planned backward from a target date.

IN USE build a workback schedule

launch readiness

The state of meeting the conditions required for release.

IN USE assess launch readiness

go/no-go decision

A decision to proceed with or stop a planned release.

IN USE hold the go/no-go review

sign-off

Recorded approval by the relevant responsible person.

IN USE obtain message sign-off

single source of truth

The agreed authoritative location for current information.

IN USE maintain a single source of truth

version control

Management of revisions so the current approved version is identifiable.

IN USE apply version control

asset specification

Requirements such as format, dimensions, or file type for an asset.

IN USE confirm the asset specification

Precision check

A target expresses an intended date; a commitment adds an agreed obligation. Ready for review differs from approved for release. List the conditions explicitly so that a shared calendar does not become mistaken evidence of completed approval.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

creative brief

Direction for developing a specific creative response.

IN USE refine the creative brief

channel mix

The combination of communication channels selected.

IN USE agree the channel mix

media booking

A commitment reserving advertising inventory.

IN USE confirm the media booking

tracking plan

A description of events and identifiers used to measure behavior.

IN USE validate the tracking plan

UTM parameter

A tagged URL field used to identify campaign traffic sources.

IN USE standardize UTM parameters

acceptance criterion

A defined condition a deliverable must meet.

IN USE set acceptance criteria

handoff

Transfer of work with the context required for the next owner.

IN USE prepare a complete handoff

approver

The person authorized to accept a particular deliverable.

IN USE identify the approver

RACI matrix

A map of responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed roles.

IN USE clarify roles in a RACI matrix

scope creep

Expansion of work beyond the agreed scope without corresponding agreement.

IN USE flag scope creep

change request

A proposed alteration to an agreed deliverable or plan.

IN USE document the change request

contingency

An alternative action prepared for a possible disruption.

IN USE agree a launch contingency

Precision check

Ownership should attach to a specific object. Priya owns the brief, the product lead approves the message, and operations checks tracking. Saying everyone owns launch can hide the person who must resolve a missing input or make the go/no-go decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

NAME THE GAP

"The calendar has channels and a date, but the brief is incomplete."

ASSIGN THE OWNER

"I own the brief; the product lead owns message approval."

PROTECT THE WORK

"You can check dimensions now without finalizing the copy."

QUALIFY THE DATE

"Monday remains the target, subject to the release conditions."

SEPARATE READINESS

"The layout is ready for discussion, not for publication."

SPECIFY THE DEPENDENCY

"Final creative depends on the audience and approved message."

DEFINE THE HANDOFF

"Please use the approved version linked from the shared brief."

CLOSE WITH CONDITIONS

"We need message sign-off and tracking checks before go/no-go."

Depends on

This phrase explains a work sequence rather than merely saying a task is late.

Subject to

Use it with explicit conditions; alone it can conceal what remains unresolved.

Ready for

Complete the phrase with review, testing, or release to identify the actual state.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

REQUEST A MEASURE

"Which defined behavior will count as campaign success?"

AVOID FALSE COMPLETION

"A placeholder is not approved wording."

CONTROL REVISIONS

"Route a new message through the change request."

SEPARATE BOOKING

"No placement has been booked, so do not report a confirmed reservation."

KEEP ONE RECORD

"Let us record decisions in the shared brief."

DESCRIBE THE IMPACT

"A late message change will affect layout and review time."

CONFIRM THE NEXT OWNER

"Who receives the asset after the review is complete?"

SUMMARIZE THE SEQUENCE

"Brief first, then final creative, checks, and release authorization."

Own versus approve

Creating or coordinating an item does not automatically confer approval authority.

Target versus confirmed

Keep this distinction on the calendar and in spoken summaries.

Placeholder

Name temporary content so another team does not mistake it for approved copy.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which update correctly describes the design state?

- A** All channel assets have completed sign-off.
- B** A layout exists, but it still contains placeholder copy.
- C** Creative is approved because the layout exists.
- D** The landing page is published but unmeasured.

2. Which sequence fits the dependencies?

- A** Approve performance, choose a metric, then draft the message.
- B** Finalize every asset before identifying the message approver.
- C** Complete the brief, finalize creative, check requirements, then authorize release.
- D** Book all media, release placeholders, then define the audience.

3. Who owns message approval under this brief?

- A** Ben as layout designer
- B** The operations lead as tracking owner
- C** The product lead
- D** Priya as shared-brief owner

4. Which statement keeps Monday accurate?

- A** Monday is guaranteed because the calendar contains it.
- B** Monday is canceled because one draft exists.
- C** Monday is approved once any team member agrees.
- D** Monday is our target; unresolved release conditions still need closure.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

A launch date without a launch-ready brief

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

asset specification / campaign brief / workback schedule / sign-off / single source of truth / change request / go/no-go decision / tracking plan / dependency / handoff

- 01 **Priya:** Sales has Monday in its calendar for email, paid social and the landing page. Before I confirm anything, what is actually ready on your side?
- 02 **Ben:** A layout with temporary copy, not final creative. I still need the
1 _____ to identify the audience, approved message and the action we're asking people to take.
- 03 **Priya:** I'll complete that document. The product lead approves the message; operations owns tracking checks. I'll list those responsibilities beside the missing inputs so we know whom to ask.
- 04 **Ben:** The approved message is a 2 _____ for my final layout. If the wording changes length or emphasis, I may need to rework more than a single headline.
- 05 **Priya:** What can you keep moving now? I want to protect useful preparation while I sort out the audience and objective, without sending temporary content into production.
- 06 **Ben:** I can verify each 3 _____: dimensions, formats and channel requirements. I'll keep the placeholder label on the text and leave these drafts out of the release folder.
- 07 **Priya:** Good. I also need to explain what could move Monday before Sales makes a customer promise. How should we show the time still needed?
- 08 **Ben:** Let's use a 4 _____ with message approval, layout revision and review before release. I'll supply the design time rather than guess that everything fits after approval arrives.
- 09 **Priya:** I'll add the success measure to the brief. We haven't decided whether the campaign should generate demo requests or another response, so the channel list isn't enough.
- 10 **Ben:** Then operations needs that decision for the 5 _____. Recording a page visit is not the same as confirming that someone completed the chosen request.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Priya:** I'll ask the product lead to approve a specific content version. A reply saying looks good will be difficult to use if several drafts are circulating.
- 12 **Ben:** Link that ⁶ _____ to the actual text. Otherwise I could apply the approval to a newer draft that the product lead has never seen.
- 13 **Priya:** Let's put the current brief, approved wording and open decisions in one shared place. Channel owners should not have to choose between conflicting email attachments.
- 14 **Ben:** That gives us a ⁷ _____. I'll link the final design from there, with its version, rather than send differently named copies to every team.
- 15 **Priya:** Suppose the offer changes after the layout is finished. Sales may still expect Monday. I need a way to explain the effect without guessing a new promise.
- 16 **Ben:** Log a ⁸ _____. I'll identify which assets and reviews are affected, then we can assess the date using that work instead of silently absorbing it.
- 17 **Priya:** No paid placement is booked yet, so there's no confirmed reservation to cancel. I'll keep Monday marked as a target while these release conditions remain open.
- 18 **Ben:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ follows the message approval and tracking checks. The calendar date itself can't stand in for those checks or authorize publication.
- 19 **Priya:** I'll update the brief today and seek the message decision. Please send the review time you need, and keep the current placeholder version clearly marked.
- 20 **Ben:** I will. The final ¹⁰ _____ will include the approved asset and its release context once those inputs are complete; today's layout is still preparation.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. campaign brief | 2. dependency | 3. asset specification | 4. workback schedule | 5. tracking plan | 6. sign-off | 7. single source of truth | 8. change request | 9. go/no-go decision | 10. handoff

One change, three affected assets

F Say it

An approved campaign has an email, landing page, and social post. A revised offer has been proposed but not approved. All three assets currently show the old offer.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

consistent / assets / approval / change

Manager: "The new offer is a proposed ¹ _____."

Designer: "It affects all three campaign ² _____."

Manager: "We need the relevant ³ _____ before release."

Designer: "I will then check that every version is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. change | 2. assets | 3. approval | 4. consistent

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Priya and Ben's corrected handoff. Identify the brief owner, message approver and tracking owner before discussing Monday.
2. Switch roles. Stress layout with placeholders, approved-message dependency and target date. Keep specifications work separate from publication readiness.
3. Read the corrected transfer twice. Preserve the proposed offer change and the need to update all three assets consistently after approval.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The how-to article that never gives instructions

04

A Read the situation

Give precise editorial feedback when a search-led article fails to deliver its stated promise.

An article targets the query "how to create a meeting agenda." Its title promises a practical guide, but the body announces a scheduling product and lists features. The content brief requires a usable agenda example and a sequence readers can follow without buying anything. Neither is in the draft. Editor Sofia and writer Ellis must restructure the article, retain only relevant product references, and check the example before publication. No ranking improvement or numerical traffic increase has been established.

PEOPLE / Sofia: Content editor | Ellis: Content writer

SEPARATE EDITORIAL JUDGMENT FROM PERSONAL TASTE

A writer can act on feedback tied to the reader's task, the title's promise, and the supplied brief. "Make it more engaging" is less usable than identifying the missing example. Be direct about the gap while preserving useful material for a more suitable format.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What task does the query indicate?

- A Learning how to create a meeting agenda
- C Comparing subscription prices

- B Reading a product-release announcement
- D Finding a company careers page

2. Which required elements are missing?

- A A paid-media budget and conversion forecast
- C An agenda example and a usable sequence

- B A competitor ranking and an award badge
- D A product-feature list and announcement

3. Which outcome cannot currently be promised?

- A A revision to the article structure
- C Removal of irrelevant product references

- B A check of the example before publication
- D A ranking improvement or traffic increase

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

search intent

The task or purpose behind a search query.

IN USE match search intent

query

The words a person enters into a search system.

IN USE interpret the query

informational intent

A search purpose focused on learning or solving a problem.

IN USE serve informational intent

commercial intent

A search purpose involving evaluation of possible purchases.

IN USE distinguish commercial intent

keyword research

Investigation of search terms and the needs they represent.

IN USE conduct keyword research

search volume

An estimate of how often a term is searched in a defined period.

IN USE interpret search volume

SERP

Search engine results page, showing results for a query.

IN USE review the SERP

content brief

Direction specifying an article's audience, purpose, scope, and requirements.

IN USE follow the content brief

editorial angle

The specific perspective or approach of a piece.

IN USE refine the editorial angle

outline

An ordered plan of a piece's sections.

IN USE revise the outline

lead paragraph

The opening paragraph that establishes the piece's direction.

IN USE rewrite the lead paragraph

subheading

A heading within a larger piece that organizes its sections.

IN USE write descriptive subheadings

Precision check

Search volume describes estimated demand for a query, not whether a draft satisfies it. A how-to title makes a content promise. An announcement can be useful elsewhere while still being the wrong response to a reader seeking practical instructions.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

worked example

A completed example demonstrating how something is done.

IN USE include a worked example

content gap

Missing material needed to meet the audience's task.

IN USE close the content gap

internal link

A link connecting pages within the same site.

IN USE add a relevant internal link

anchor text

The visible linked wording describing a destination.

IN USE use descriptive anchor text

metadata

Information describing or supporting a page outside its main body.

IN USE review page metadata

title tag

An HTML element specifying a page's title for systems and displays.

IN USE align the title tag

meta description

A page summary that a search engine may use in a snippet.

IN USE write a useful meta description

canonical URL

The preferred representative URL for duplicate or similar pages.

IN USE specify the canonical URL

crawlability

The ability of a crawler to access page content.

IN USE check crawlability

indexability

Whether a page can be included in a search engine's index.

IN USE investigate indexability

thought leadership

Content offering a supported, useful perspective on a field.

IN USE substantiate thought leadership

editorial review

Assessment of accuracy, usefulness, structure, and publication readiness.

IN USE complete editorial review

Precision check

Crawlability, indexability, and ranking are different questions. A technically accessible page is not guaranteed a high position. Likewise, a clear title or meta description does not guarantee exactly how a search system will display the result.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE READER TASK

"The searcher wants to create an agenda, not read a launch announcement."

PRESERVE USEFUL WORK

"The feature summary may belong in the product announcement."

CHECK INDEPENDENCE

"Can the reader use this guidance without buying the product?"

AVOID A FORECAST

"We can improve the article's fit without promising a ranking increase."

IDENTIFY THE GAP

"The title promises a guide, but the required example is missing."

REQUEST A STRUCTURE

"Start with the steps, then show a completed agenda."

LIMIT PROMOTION

"Keep product references only where they help the stated task."

CLOSE WITH REVIEW

"We will check the example and title against the revised body."

Promises versus covers

Compare what a heading leads readers to expect with what the body actually supplies.

May belong

This phrase redirects usable material without calling it universally bad.

How to

A how-to title sets an expectation of practical process, not just product benefits.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

MAKE FEEDBACK CONCRETE

"Add the decision, owner, and time allocation to the agenda example."

REVIEW LINKS

"Use descriptive link text that matches the destination."

CHECK THE PROMISE

"Does each main section help deliver what the title offers?"

SPECIFY THE OPENING

"The first paragraph should address the reader's immediate task."

CLARIFY THE ANGLE

"This piece teaches a process rather than announcing availability."

SEPARATE TECHNICAL CHECKS

"Being accessible to a crawler is not the same as ranking well."

RETAIN ACCURACY

"Do not invent usage results to make the guide sound authoritative."

MARK THE NEXT STEP

"Return the revised outline before polishing the final copy."

Without buying

This condition makes the usefulness requirement in this particular brief concrete.

Can improve versus will rank

An editorial improvement and a guaranteed search outcome are different claims.

Relevant link

Relevance depends on the reader's task and the actual destination.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which feedback most directly resolves the stated problem?

- A** Add a traffic forecast to justify the existing draft.
- B** Add the required sequence and worked agenda before refining promotional copy.
- C** Increase keyword repetition while leaving the announcement unchanged.
- D** Replace the title with a stronger how-to promise without changing the body.

2. Which sentence correctly limits the search claim?

- A** Better task alignment does not guarantee a ranking increase.
- B** A useful example guarantees first position.
- C** Indexability proves the content is the best result.
- D** Search volume guarantees visits to this particular page.

3. Which use of the feature summary best fits the brief?

- A** Place every feature before the first instruction.
- B** Treat the feature list as the complete agenda example.
- C** Remove the required sequence to shorten the piece.
- D** Move the general announcement elsewhere and retain only task-relevant references.

4. Which check most directly verifies that the guide delivers its promised instruction?

- A** Confirm the agenda example follows the steps and can be used without purchase
- B** Confirm the keyword has an attractive search-volume estimate
- C** Confirm the product announcement uses the latest brand colors
- D** Confirm the article contains more internal links than the old draft

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

The how-to article that never gives instructions

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

search volume / content gap / lead paragraph / anchor text / editorial review / search intent / crawlability / outline / worked example / title tag

- 01 **Sofia:** The title promises a guide to creating a meeting agenda, but the opening announces our product. What does the searcher need to do?
- 02 **Ellis:** The ¹ _____ is practical. Someone needs an agenda they can build and use, not simply a list of reasons to buy our scheduling product.
- 03 **Sofia:** Exactly. The brief requires a usable example and a sequence that works without a purchase. I cannot find either in the current draft.
- 04 **Ellis:** That is the central ² _____. I used the feature summary as the body, so the title now promises a kind of help the article does not deliver.
- 05 **Sofia:** The feature summary may still be useful for the announcement. Let us avoid discarding good material just because it is in the wrong place.
- 06 **Ellis:** I will revise the ³ _____ around the reader's task first: define the meeting outcome, choose the topics, assign owners, and allocate time before sharing the agenda.
- 07 **Sofia:** Then show the result. Readers should not have to guess what that sequence produces when they try to use it for an actual meeting.
- 08 **Ellis:** I can add a ⁴ _____ with a meeting objective, timed topics, and owners. We can check it against the steps before I polish the final wording.
- 09 **Sofia:** Start with the agenda problem. Could a reader use the opening to begin the task without first learning about our product launch?
- 10 **Ellis:** I will rewrite the ⁵ _____ so it introduces the agenda problem. The product mention can appear later only if it genuinely helps a step.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Sofia:** How will you handle links? A repeated invitation to learn more does not tell the reader what they will find after leaving the guide.
- 12 **Ellis:** I will use descriptive ⁶ _____ for a relevant template or related explanation. I will also check that each destination actually provides what the linked words promise.
- 13 **Sofia:** The keyword has a large estimated search volume. Someone may ask whether fixing the article means we can promise a specific increase in visits.
- 14 **Ellis:** No. ⁷ _____ describes estimated searches, not our guaranteed traffic. We can explain the editorial improvement without inventing a ranking or numerical performance result.
- 15 **Sofia:** The page settings also need review. I do not want the displayed promise and the revised body to drift apart during production.
- 16 **Ellis:** I will align the ⁸ _____ with the actual guide and check the summary text. That still does not let us dictate every search-result presentation.
- 17 **Sofia:** Technical colleagues will check access separately. We should not describe that check as proof that the content is useful or certain to rank.
- 18 **Ellis:** Agreed. ⁹ _____ answers whether a crawler can access the page. It is a different issue from whether our example gives the reader workable instructions.
- 19 **Sofia:** Send me the outline and one complete agenda example. I would rather review those now than polish another version that still misses the searcher's question.
- 20 **Ellis:** I will return those for ¹⁰ _____. The finished piece should deliver the title's promise, while the announcement carries the broader feature story in its proper place.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. search intent | 2. content gap | 3. outline | 4. worked example | 5. lead paragraph | 6. anchor text | 7. search volume | 8. title tag | 9. crawlability | 10. editorial review

A comparison page with no comparison

F Say it

A page promises to compare two service plans. The draft describes only Plan A. The current plan documents are available; neither plan has been selected for the reader.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

documents / both / comparison / choice

Editor: "The title promises a ¹ _____."

Writer: "I need the relevant terms for ² _____ plans."

Editor: "Use the current plan ³ _____ for factual details."

Writer: "I will not present one plan as the reader's completed ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. comparison | 2. both | 3. documents | 4. choice

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected editorial exchange. Keep the reader's agenda-building task beside the missing sequence and worked example.
2. Switch roles. Read the request for task-relevant content, a checked example and a matching title without promising a search ranking.
3. Read the corrected plan-comparison transfer twice. Retain both plans and their current documents; do not replace comparison with promotion of Plan A.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The campaign and the discount changed together

A Read the situation

05

Explain reported performance while resisting an unsupported claim of incremental impact.

A paid campaign reports 80 attributed orders in week one and 120 in week two, with \$2,400 media spend in each week. The campaign creative changed at the start of week two, and a 20% storewide discount began that same day. The attribution model and reporting window were unchanged, but there was no control group. Analyst Darius and growth lead Mae review a slide claiming the creative caused 40 additional orders. Revenue, margin, and total acquisition costs have not been supplied.

PEOPLE / Darius: Marketing analyst | Mae: Growth lead

CORRECT THE CAUSAL VERB, NOT THE USEFUL RESULT

A report can show a genuine increase without proving what caused it. Keep the observed result and cost calculation, then explain what is missing from the causal claim. This helps colleagues use the data without feeling that every positive result is being dismissed.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the reported cost per attributed order in week two?

A \$20

B \$30

C \$40

D \$50

2. Which two factors changed together?

A Creative and the storewide discount

B The attribution model and reporting window

C Media spend and a control-group assignment

D Margin and the definition of revenue

3. What prevents the slide's causal conclusion?

A The before-and-after data do not isolate creative from the concurrent discount.

B The reported order count did not increase.

C The media spend increased by 50%.

D A controlled experiment showed no creative effect.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

impression

A recorded display of advertising under a platform's definition.

IN USE count ad impressions

reach

The distinct audience estimated to have been exposed.

IN USE report unique reach

frequency

Average exposures per reached person under a defined calculation.

IN USE monitor ad frequency

click-through rate

Clicks divided by impressions on a stated basis.

IN USE compare click-through rates

cost per click

Advertising spend divided by recorded clicks.

IN USE calculate cost per click

cost per mille

Cost per thousand impressions.

IN USE compare cost per mille

cost per acquisition

Cost divided by defined acquisition actions within a stated scope.

IN USE specify the cost-per-acquisition basis

return on ad spend

Attributed revenue divided by advertising spend under a stated method.

IN USE qualify return on ad spend

attribution model

Rules or methods assigning credit for a conversion to interactions.

IN USE identify the attribution model

attribution window

The time interval in which an interaction can receive conversion credit.

IN USE confirm the attribution window

last-click attribution

A model assigning credit to the last eligible click.

IN USE interpret last-click attribution

view-through conversion

A conversion credited after an eligible ad view without a qualifying click.

IN USE separate view-through conversions

Precision check

Orders attributed to a channel are not automatically orders caused by that channel. Here, media spend per attributed order fell from \$30 to \$20. That arithmetic is supported; a claim that the creative generated all 40 extra orders is not.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

incrementality

The additional outcome caused by an intervention relative to its absence.

IN USE estimate incrementality

holdout group

A group withheld from an intervention for comparison.

IN USE define the holdout group

confounder

A factor that complicates attributing an observed relationship to one cause.

IN USE identify a possible confounder

baseline

A defined starting or comparison level.

IN USE document the baseline

conversion lag

Delay between an interaction and a recorded conversion.

IN USE account for conversion lag

deduplication

Removing duplicate records so the same event is not counted repeatedly.

IN USE apply conversion deduplication

pixel

Tracking code or a small resource used to record events.

IN USE validate the tracking pixel

bid strategy

Rules governing how advertising bids are set.

IN USE review the bid strategy

budget pacing

Management of spending across the planned campaign period.

IN USE adjust budget pacing

creative fatigue

Reduced response associated with repeated exposure to the same creative.

IN USE investigate creative fatigue

audience overlap

Shared people across two or more target groups.

IN USE measure audience overlap

blended acquisition cost

Acquisition cost calculated across a specified combined set of channels or costs.

IN USE define blended acquisition cost

Precision check

Cost per order is not profit. Revenue, margin, returns, and costs beyond media are missing. Keep the metric label attached to the numerator and denominator, and avoid relabeling a platform cost metric as total customer-acquisition cost without the required inputs.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LEAD WITH THE RESULT

"Attributed orders rose from 80 to 120 at the same media spend."

NAME THE CONCURRENT CHANGE

"The storewide discount began when the creative changed."

PRESERVE THE USEFUL FINDING

"The reported improvement is real in the stated reporting data."

REQUEST A STRONGER DESIGN

"We need an appropriate comparison to estimate incremental impact."

STATE THE COST BASIS

"Media cost per attributed order fell from \$30 to \$20."

LIMIT CAUSALITY

"This comparison does not isolate the effect of the creative."

DEFINE ATTRIBUTION

"The platform assigns credit under its model and window."

CLOSE WITH ACCURATE WORDING

"Report the increase without assigning all of it to the creative."

After versus because of

After describes timing; because of attributes causation.

Attributed versus incremental

Attributed reflects reporting credit; incremental concerns additional outcomes caused.

Per order

Keep the unit explicit, especially when repeat orders differ from new customers.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE PROFITABILITY

"We do not have the revenue or margin data for that conclusion."

ALLOW FOR LAG

"Some conversions may be recorded after the first report."

AVOID METRIC SUBSTITUTION

"Media cost per order is not automatically total acquisition cost."

KEEP THE DISCOUNT VISIBLE

"The promotion is a material part of the comparison."

CHECK THE WINDOW

"Use the same reporting window before comparing the figures."

CHECK DUPLICATION

"Confirm whether overlapping sources count the same order."

IDENTIFY THE DENOMINATOR

"Are these orders, customers, or another conversion action?"

DESCRIBE UNCERTAINTY

"The creative may have contributed; its separate effect remains unmeasured."

Fell from and to

Stating both endpoints makes the improvement auditable.

May have contributed

This preserves a possible explanation without declaring a measured causal effect.

Same spend

Holding one factor constant does not mean all other relevant factors were controlled.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which headline matches the evidence?

- A** The discount had no effect because spend was unchanged.
- B** Profit rose 50% because attributed orders rose 50%.
- C** Attributed orders rose 50% while creative and the discount changed together.
- D** New creative caused a verified 50% incremental order lift.

2. Which metric can be calculated from the supplied data?

- A** Total lifetime customer value
- B** Incremental return on investment
- C** Media cost per attributed order
- D** Net profit per acquired customer

3. What does unchanged attribution establish?

- A** The discount contributed no orders.
- B** The reported conversions are all new customers.
- C** The stated credit method stayed consistent, not that creative caused the increase.
- D** The creative's causal contribution is exactly 40 orders.

4. Which revision avoids overstating the result?

- A** Keep caused but put the discount in an unrelated appendix.
- B** Omit week one so no comparison can be checked.
- C** Rename attributed orders as incremental orders.
- D** Replace caused with accompanied and disclose the concurrent promotion.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The campaign and the discount changed together

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

confounder / blended acquisition cost / baseline / attribution model / holdout group / return on ad spend / incrementality / conversion lag / attribution / cost per acquisition

- 01 **Mae:** The slide says the new creative caused forty additional orders. Orders rose from eighty to one hundred twenty, so the story looks strong.
- 02 **Darius:** The increase is clear in the ¹ _____ report. The problem is the word caused, because the storewide discount started on the same day as the creative change.
- 03 **Mae:** We kept media spend at twenty-four hundred dollars in both weeks. Does that at least support the claim that the campaign became more efficient?
- 04 **Darius:** On the specified ² _____ measure, yes: media spend per attributed order fell from thirty dollars to twenty. We should keep that exact cost and action basis in the label.
- 05 **Mae:** I was going to call it total customer-acquisition cost. We do not have sales costs or a count of newly acquired customers, though.
- 06 **Darius:** Then that label would be too broad. A ³ _____ requires defined included costs and a suitable denominator. The platform's attributed orders may not all represent new customers.
- 07 **Mae:** The report uses the same model as last week. I thought that would make it fair to credit the entire increase to the campaign change.
- 08 **Darius:** A stable ⁴ _____ makes the reporting method consistent. It does not remove the discount or tell us how orders would have changed without the new creative.
- 09 **Mae:** Then the numbers can stay, but the creative-caused-it headline cannot. How should we explain the discount without making the whole report sound useless?
- 10 **Darius:** Exactly. It is a possible ⁵ _____. Both changes could influence orders, and the simple before-and-after comparison cannot separate their effects.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Mae:** What evidence would let us discuss the creative's additional contribution more confidently, rather than just repeat the platform's allocation of credit?
- 12 **Darius:** We would need a suitable design for measuring ⁶ _____, with the relevant comparison and assumptions reviewed. This report alone cannot supply the outcome that would have occurred without the creative change.
- 13 **Mae:** Would withholding the new creative from a comparable group help, provided the promotional conditions and measurement were planned properly?
- 14 **Darius:** A carefully designed ⁷ _____ could be part of that approach. We would need to review assignment, exposure, and other differences before interpreting a result as causal.
- 15 **Mae:** For today's update, I can state the order increase and lower media cost per order. Can I also say return on ad spend improved?
- 16 **Darius:** We have no revenue figure, so we cannot calculate ⁸ _____. The discount also makes it especially important not to assume that more orders mean the same proportional revenue or profit increase.
- 17 **Mae:** Have both weeks had the same time to collect late orders? I do not want to compare a mature week with a count that is still growing.
- 18 **Darius:** Yes, check the ⁹ _____ and keep the reporting window explicit. We should also confirm duplicate-order handling before combining results from different sources.
- 19 **Mae:** Then the slide will say attributed orders rose fifty percent while creative and the discount changed together. Their separate effects remain unmeasured.
- 20 **Darius:** That preserves the improvement against the stated ¹⁰ _____. We can recommend a stronger measurement plan without turning a useful observation into a causal claim the evidence cannot support.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. attribution | 2. cost per acquisition | 3. blended acquisition cost | 4. attribution model | 5. confounder | 6. incrementality | 7. holdout group | 8. return on ad spend | 9. conversion lag | 10. baseline

Two dashboards, one order

F Say it

Two advertising platforms each claim credit for the same single order. The sales system records one order. No experiment has isolated either platform's incremental effect.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

deduplication / incrementality / order / attribution

Analyst: "The sales record contains one ¹ _____."

Lead: "Combining platform counts requires ² _____."

Analyst: "Credit assignment is ³ _____, not proof of cause."

Lead: "Neither report alone establishes ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. order | 2. deduplication | 3. attribution | 4. incrementality

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected campaign review. State 80 to 120 attributed orders and \$30 to \$20 media cost per order at unchanged spend.

2. Switch roles. Keep the concurrent 20% discount visible; attribution credit is not an isolated creative effect, revenue or profit.

3. Read the corrected transfer. Count one sales order across the overlapping dashboard claims without inventing either platform's incremental contribution.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A hundred contacts are not a hundred sales requests

A Read the situation

Clarify lifecycle status and routing rules without turning activity records into invented buying intent.

06

A campaign export contains 100 contacts: 20 submitted a demonstration request, 60 downloaded a guide, and 20 have no recorded source. Contact permissions and suppression status have not been checked. The company's stated handoff procedure requires a verified source, a documented sales request, completed permission checks, and a named owner before a record is routed as sales-ready. Marketing-operations specialist Jules and sales-development lead Nico must correct an email calling all 100 contacts ready for sales outreach.

PEOPLE / Jules: Marketing-operations specialist | Nico: Sales-development lead

A SHARED LABEL NEEDS A SHARED THRESHOLD

Sales and marketing may use the same word for different stages. Ask what event and checks the label represents before debating lead quality. This keeps the discussion factual and avoids blaming either team for a handoff whose rules were never applied consistently.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many contacts have a documented demonstration request?

- A 80
- C 20

- B 100
- D 60

2. What remains unchecked across the export?

- A Contact permissions and suppression status
- C The existence of 20 demonstration requests

- B Whether all records contain a source
- D Whether a guide-download category exists

3. Can all 100 records currently be called sales-ready under the stated procedure?

- A Yes; an email address is sufficient under the stated procedure.
- C No; the company prohibits responding to any demonstration request.

- B Yes; downloading a guide is the same as requesting a sales call.
- D No; the request, source, checks, and ownership conditions are not all met.

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

CRM

Customer relationship management system or practice for relationship records.

IN USE update the CRM record

lifecycle stage

A defined position in a contact's relationship with the organization.

IN USE verify the lifecycle stage

lead

A potential customer record whose qualification depends on agreed criteria.

IN USE review a new lead

marketing-qualified lead

A lead meeting the organization's stated marketing qualification criteria.

IN USE define a marketing-qualified lead

sales-qualified lead

A lead meeting the organization's stated sales qualification criteria.

IN USE confirm a sales-qualified lead

lead scoring

Applying defined values to attributes or behavior to prioritize leads.

IN USE calibrate lead scoring

fit score

A score representing alignment with the target customer profile.

IN USE review the fit score

intent signal

Behavior suggesting interest without necessarily proving a buying decision.

IN USE interpret an intent signal

lead source

The recorded origin of a contact or lead.

IN USE verify the lead source

source provenance

The traceable history of how data was obtained.

IN USE preserve source provenance

consent record

A record of permission with relevant scope and context.

IN USE check the consent record

suppression list

Records excluded from specified communication activity.

IN USE apply the suppression list

Precision check

A downloaded guide is a recorded action, not a stated request for a sales conversation. Qualification labels are organization-specific. This case supplies its own handoff conditions; do not replace them with an assumed universal meaning of MQL or SQL.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

unsubscribe

A request or action to stop a type of communication.

IN USE process an unsubscribe

preference center

A place where recipients manage communication choices.

IN USE update the preference center

double opt-in

A process confirming a subscription through a second action.

IN USE document the double opt-in

deliverability

The ability of messages to reach their intended inbox destination.

IN USE monitor deliverability

hard bounce

A delivery failure generally indicating a persistent address problem.

IN USE suppress a hard bounce

soft bounce

A delivery failure often associated with a temporary condition.

IN USE investigate a soft bounce

nurture sequence

A planned series of communications supporting a relationship over time.

IN USE review the nurture sequence

triggered email

A message initiated by a defined event or condition.

IN USE test the triggered email

segmentation rule

A criterion used to assign records to an audience group.

IN USE validate a segmentation rule

routing rule

A condition determining which owner receives a record or task.

IN USE apply the routing rule

service-level agreement

An agreement defining service responsibilities and response expectations.

IN USE clarify the service-level agreement

recycle reason

A recorded explanation for returning a lead to an earlier process stage.

IN USE document the recycle reason

Precision check

A permission record needs context such as channel, purpose, and status. Do not infer universal legal permission or prohibition from the presence of an address. Apply the supplied company procedure and obtain qualified review of the actual jurisdictions and communication types.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CORRECT THE COUNT

"Twenty contacts requested demonstrations; the other records have different statuses."

NAME THE MISSING CHECK

"Permissions and suppression status remain unverified."

PRESERVE THE SOURCE

"Keep the original event and source history in the CRM."

AVOID AN INVENTED STATUS

"Unknown source should remain unknown until verified."

SEPARATE ACTIONS

"A guide download is not a documented sales request."

APPLY THE THRESHOLD

"Use the stated handoff criteria before marking a record sales-ready."

ASSIGN AN OWNER

"Each eligible handoff needs a named receiving owner."

CLOSE WITH ROUTING

"Route the verified requests through the agreed process."

06

Requested versus downloaded

These verbs describe different actions and must not be treated as interchangeable intent.

Qualified for what

A label needs the next action and applicable threshold.

Unknown versus absent

An unknown permission status is not evidence of either permission or a confirmed opt-out.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE LABEL

"What conditions does qualified represent in this workflow?"

LIMIT THE BATCH

"Do not describe the entire export as a single audience."

REQUEST THE TRAIL

"Please attach the source event and current status."

PROTECT THE RECORD

"Do not overwrite the original source to make the export look complete."

KEEP CHECKS DISTINCT

"A demonstration request does not erase a separate suppression check."

CHECK SCOPE

"Does the permission record cover this channel and purpose?"

EXPLAIN A RETURN

"Use a specific recycle reason rather than simply rejecting the lead."

MEASURE THE HANDOFF

"Count records that meet the criteria, not every row in the file."

06

Pending checks

This phrase records an unfinished process without inventing its eventual result.

Every row versus eligible records

The denominator changes when a report filters by handoff conditions.

Company procedure

The supplied operational rule is not a statement of all jurisdictions' legal requirements.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which handoff summary is accurate?

- A** Twenty demonstration requests are identified, with required checks still pending.
- B** One hundred contacts requested a sales conversation.
- C** Sixty guide downloads prove purchase authority.
- D** All unknown-source contacts have already opted out.

2. Which action preserves record integrity?

- A** Retain the original source and mark unverified fields for review.
- B** Replace all sources with demonstration request to simplify routing.
- C** Delete suppression flags when a campaign target is missed.
- D** Call unknown permission confirmed because an address exists.

3. Which record fits every stated sales-ready condition?

- A** A documented request with verified source, completed permission checks and a named owner
- B** A documented request with an assigned owner but pending suppression checks
- C** A guide download with checked permissions and a high engagement score
- D** A named sales owner and verified email address but no recorded source

4. Which question resolves a qualification disagreement?

- A** Which event and completed checks does this stage require?
- B** Which team should own every unsuccessful sale?
- C** Can we use qualified without defining it?
- D** Should source evidence be removed to avoid delay?

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

A hundred contacts are not a hundred sales requests

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

source provenance / suppression list / service-level agreement / routing rule / recycle reason / lead source / intent signal / consent record / CRM / lifecycle stage

- 01 **Nico:** The campaign email says we have one hundred sales-ready contacts. Before my team starts outreach, can you show me what those people actually requested?
- 02 **Jules:** The ¹ _____ export has twenty demonstration requests, sixty guide downloads, and twenty records with no source. Those are three different situations, not one consistent sales-ready group.
- 03 **Nico:** The downloaders have shown interest, though. Could we describe that as enough intent for a sales call and route them with the demonstration requests?
- 04 **Jules:** A download is an ² _____, but it is not the documented sales request our procedure requires. We should preserve what happened rather than strengthen the event's meaning.
- 05 **Nico:** That makes sense. What about the twenty people who explicitly asked for a demonstration? Are their records ready to assign now?
- 06 **Jules:** Their ³ _____ is recorded, but permissions and suppression status have not been checked. The request does not by itself complete every condition in the handoff procedure.
- 07 **Nico:** Those twenty people asked for a demo; I do not want them forgotten. Can you flag the checks still needed and give each request an owner?
- 08 **Jules:** Yes. Keep the ⁴ _____ accurate, with the missing checks visible. A pending state should tell the next colleague what remains, not become a place where requests disappear.
- 09 **Nico:** For the permission check, should we look only for a yes or no field? Some contacts have older records from another campaign.
- 10 **Jules:** Review the ⁵ _____ with its channel, purpose, and status. An old flag without context is not a complete answer for this particular communication.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Nico:** And if a current suppression record is present, the team should not assume the new export has somehow removed that restriction.
- 12 **Jules:** Correct. Apply the relevant ⁶ _____ through the approved process. We should resolve any apparent conflict through review, not silently overwrite the status to increase the handoff count.
- 13 **Nico:** Once a request meets the criteria, I need it assigned to a specific person. Otherwise both teams may assume the other one is responding.
- 14 **Jules:** The ⁷ _____ should identify that owner and preserve the source event. I will include the completed checks so the receiving colleague does not have to reconstruct the history.
- 15 **Nico:** We also need to agree how quickly eligible requests are acknowledged. That is a different conversation from inventing a deadline for unchecked records.
- 16 **Jules:** We can record it in the ⁸ _____. The agreement should name the responsible team and what happens if the record is incomplete, rather than hide those cases in an average.
- 17 **Nico:** Suppose sales returns a record because the requested topic is outside our service. A generic rejection makes it hard to improve the next campaign.
- 18 **Jules:** Use a specific ⁹ _____. That distinguishes a scope mismatch from missing information or an unanswered request without blaming the contact or changing the original event.
- 19 **Nico:** I will correct the hundred-sales-ready claim now. Send me the status of the twenty demo requests and keep the downloaders and unknown sources separate.
- 20 **Jules:** I will keep the ¹⁰ _____ intact and investigate the unknown sources. We will count completed eligible handoffs, not relabel all one hundred rows to meet the campaign headline.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. CRM | 2. intent signal | 3. lead source | 4. lifecycle stage | 5. consent record | 6. suppression list | 7. routing rule | 8. service-level agreement | 9. recycle reason | 10. source provenance

An export does not renew a preference

F Say it

A contact is on the company's current suppression list for promotional email. A later event export includes the same address but supplies no new preference information. The team has not reviewed the conflict.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

preference / address / record / process

Operator: "The export contains the same ¹ _____."

Lead: "It does not establish a changed ² _____."

Operator: "I will preserve the existing suppression ³ _____."

Lead: "Resolve the conflict through the approved ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. address | 2. preference | 3. record | 4. process

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected contact handoff. Separate 20 demonstration requests, 60 guide downloads and 20 unknown-source records.
2. Switch roles. Preserve source verification, permission and suppression checks, documented request and receiving owner as distinct conditions under this company's procedure.
3. Read the corrected transfer twice. Keep the existing suppression record when the later export supplies no changed preference.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A higher click rate is not yet a declared winner

A Read the situation

Present absolute and relative differences while keeping statistical and commercial conclusions separate.

An email test reports 120 unique clickers among 2,000 delivered messages for A and 140 among 2,000 for B. These are the only supplied results. The random assignment, planned stopping rule, and statistical analysis have not yet been checked. No purchase data are available. Director Anika wants to announce B as a proven winner. Analyst Mateo must explain the observed rates and their difference, then identify the checks required before a stronger claim or broader release decision.

PEOPLE / Anika: Marketing director | Mateo: Experimentation analyst

07

GIVE THE CLEAR NUMBER BEFORE THE QUALIFICATION

An executive can need a short answer without needing an overstated answer. Lead with the observed difference, then say what is not established and which check resolves it. Avoid burying the result under statistical vocabulary or letting a request for decisiveness turn an unfinished analysis into proof.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What are the observed unique clicker rates?

A A: 60%; B: 70%

B A: 6%; B: 14%

C A: 6%; B: 7%

D A: 12%; B: 14%

2. What is the absolute difference between those rates?

A 1 percent relative

B 20 percentage points

C 16.7 percentage points

D 1 percentage point

3. Which conclusion is currently unsupported?

A B is a statistically established and commercially superior winner

B B has 20 more observed unique clickers

C Both reported delivery counts are 2,000

D B's observed clicker rate is higher

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

A/B test

A comparison of two variants under a specified experimental design.

IN USE plan an A/B test

control variant

The reference experience used for comparison.

IN USE define the control variant

treatment variant

The changed experience whose effect is assessed.

IN USE describe the treatment variant

randomization

Assignment by a chance-based process intended to support comparable groups.

IN USE verify randomization

randomization unit

The entity assigned to an experiment condition.

IN USE choose the randomization unit

sample size

The number of observations or assigned units on a defined basis.

IN USE determine the sample size

sample ratio mismatch

An unexpected departure from the intended allocation proportions.

IN USE investigate a sample ratio mismatch

primary metric

The preselected main measure for evaluating an experiment.

IN USE specify the primary metric

guardrail metric

A measure used to detect unacceptable adverse effects.

IN USE monitor a guardrail metric

denominator

The quantity by which a numerator is divided.

IN USE verify the denominator

percentage point

The unit for an absolute difference between percentages.

IN USE report a percentage-point change

relative lift

Change divided by the baseline value, expressed on a relative basis.

IN USE calculate relative lift

Precision check

The observed rates are 6% for A and 7% for B: the absolute difference is one percentage point. Relative to 6%, the increase is about 16.7%. Twenty extra observed clickers, one percentage point, and 16.7% relative lift describe different aspects of the same counts.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

confidence interval

A range produced by a method with a stated long-run coverage property.

IN USE report a confidence interval

p-value

Probability, under the null model, of results at least as extreme as observed.

IN USE interpret the p-value

statistical significance

A result meeting a specified statistical decision criterion.

IN USE assess statistical significance

practical significance

The size and relevance of an effect for an actual decision.

IN USE distinguish practical significance

statistical power

Probability of detecting a specified effect under an assumed design.

IN USE assess statistical power

minimum detectable effect

A target effect size a planned design aims to detect reliably.

IN USE specify the minimum detectable effect

stopping rule

A planned rule for when an experiment ends or is evaluated.

IN USE follow the stopping rule

multiple testing

Evaluation of multiple hypotheses, with associated error-control concerns.

IN USE account for multiple testing

cohort

A group defined by a shared entry period or characteristic.

IN USE compare like-for-like cohorts

funnel stage

A defined step in a progression toward an outcome.

IN USE distinguish funnel stages

drop-off

The loss of participants between specified stages.

IN USE measure stage-to-stage drop-off

executive readout

A concise presentation of findings, limits, and decision implications.

IN USE prepare the executive readout

Precision check

Higher observed performance does not itself establish statistical significance or business value. A clicker is not necessarily a purchaser. Missing analysis is not evidence of no effect either: report the observation and the unresolved checks without declaring either certainty or failure.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE OBSERVATION

"A recorded 6% and B recorded 7% unique clicker rates."

GIVE THE RELATIVE BASIS

"Relative to A's 6%, the observed increase is about 16.7%."

REQUEST THE DESIGN CHECK

"Confirm assignment and the planned stopping rule."

AVOID THE OPPOSITE ERROR

"Unfinished analysis does not prove that there is no effect."

NAME THE ABSOLUTE CHANGE

"The difference is one percentage point."

LIMIT THE VERDICT

"B is higher in this sample; a proven winner is not yet established."

SEPARATE THE OUTCOME

"We have click data, not purchase or revenue results."

CLOSE WITH NEXT STEPS

"Finish the design and statistical checks before the stronger claim."

07

Percentage point

Use this for subtraction between two percentages, not for the relative ratio.

Relative to

This phrase names the baseline used in a relative-change calculation.

Observed

This qualifier distinguishes the actual sample result from a population or causal conclusion.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE DENOMINATOR

"Each rate uses 2,000 delivered messages."

ASK FOR UNCERTAINTY

"Include the appropriate uncertainty estimate with the result."

PROTECT THE WIDER DECISION

"Review relevant adverse outcomes before a broader release."

CLARIFY THE SCOPE

"This result does not describe every future audience."

IDENTIFY THE COUNT

"B has 20 more observed unique clickers."

CHECK THE METRIC

"Was this the preselected primary measure?"

KEEP TIMING VISIBLE

"Are both groups measured over the same follow-up period?"

SUMMARIZE FOR LEADERS

"The observed direction is positive; the decision checks remain open."

07

Not yet established

This is different from saying disproved or impossible.

Unique clickers

Count distinct clickers under the reporting method, not repeat clicks. A tracking identifier should not be assumed to prove a distinct human without validation.

Winner

Define the statistical and practical criteria before using the label as a decision.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which sentence reports both forms of change accurately?

- A** B is one percentage point higher, about 16.7% above A on a relative basis.
- B** B is 16.7 percentage points higher and 1% above A.
- C** B is one percentage point higher and therefore 1% better relatively.
- D** B is twenty percentage points higher because it has twenty more clickers.

07

2. Which statement keeps the measured outcome distinct from a business result?

- A** B has a higher order conversion rate because clicker rate increased.
- B** B has greater revenue per delivered message at the same observed rates.
- C** B has a higher customer-acquisition rate because the group sizes match.
- D** B has a higher observed unique-clicker rate; purchase outcomes are not supplied.

3. What is a justified next step?

- A** Declare significance because both groups contain 2,000 deliveries.
- B** Stop all analysis because a larger observed count always decides the result.
- C** State that B has no effect because analysis is unfinished.
- D** Verify design, stopping rule, and statistical analysis before declaring a proven winner.

4. Which readout is appropriately concise?

- A** The test proves a 16.7-point revenue increase.
- B** Nothing can be reported until a purchase occurs.
- C** B's observed rate is higher; the statistical and commercial conclusions remain open.
- D** B is guaranteed to increase purchases in every audience.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

A higher click rate is not yet a declared winner

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Practical significance / confidence interval / stopping rule / primary metric / denominator / statistical significance / executive readout / percentage point / relative lift / randomization

07

- 01 **Anika:** B shows one hundred forty clickers against A's one hundred twenty. I'd like to tell the leadership team B wins and send it to everyone.
- 02 **Mateo:** We can report the observation first. With a ¹ _____ of two thousand delivered messages for each version, A's rate is six percent and B's is seven.
- 03 **Anika:** I'll say one percent better, then. Is that precise enough, or will readers understand a different calculation from the one we actually have?
- 04 **Mateo:** Use one ² _____ for the absolute difference. One percent better can sound like a relative comparison, which uses A's rate as the base.
- 05 **Anika:** That relative number would be one divided by six, about sixteen point seven percent. It sounds much larger than the difference between six and seven.
- 06 **Mateo:** That's the ³ _____, not an extra improvement. Put both original rates beside it so the audience can see the size and basis of the same change.
- 07 **Anika:** Both groups have two thousand delivered messages. Doesn't that show they were comparable, or is there something else you need to verify in the setup?
- 08 **Mateo:** We still need to verify ⁴ _____. Equal delivered counts don't tell us how recipients were assigned or whether the reported groups follow the intended design.
- 09 **Anika:** The team watched the dashboard repeatedly during the send. I don't know whether they stopped because B looked ahead or because the planned endpoint arrived.
- 10 **Mateo:** We'll check the ⁵ _____. Monitoring is not itself proof of a problem, but outcome-driven stopping can change the analysis needed to support a conclusion.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Anika:** So twenty extra clickers isn't enough to call it statistically significant just by looking at the totals? I need a clear reason to hold that label.
- 12 **Mateo:** We haven't completed the analysis for ⁶ _____. A larger observed count alone doesn't establish that conclusion, and we should not turn an unfinished check into proof of no effect either.
- 13 **Anika:** The dashboard's green arrow makes it look settled. What can we place beside the rates to show uncertainty once the design has been checked?
- 14 **Mateo:** An appropriate ⁷ _____ can help. We don't have one calculated in this report, so I'll add the checked estimate rather than invent bounds for the slide.
- 15 **Anika:** And even if the click difference holds up, we don't know whether people bought anything. I can't present a click result as additional revenue.
- 16 **Mateo:** Right. ⁸ _____ asks whether the effect matters to the decision. We need the relevant business outcomes and costs before calling this commercially superior.
- 17 **Anika:** Was clicker rate our main measure before the send? I don't want us to choose it now just because it happens to favor B.
- 18 **Mateo:** I'll confirm the ⁹ _____ and the other planned measures, including adverse outcomes. We need the original decision criteria, not a selection of the most flattering results.
- 19 **Anika:** Then today's headline will report six versus seven percent, one percentage point apart, with the design and analysis checks open. No proven-winner label or full-send approval.
- 20 **Mateo:** That makes a clear ¹⁰ _____. I'll name the outstanding checks beneath the observed result, and we'll return to the broader decision with the missing evidence.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. denominator | 2. percentage point | 3. relative lift | 4. randomization | 5. stopping rule | 6. statistical significance | 7. confidence interval | 8. Practical significance | 9. primary metric | 10. executive readout

A bigger numerator, a lower rate

F Say it

Campaign C receives 90 requests from 1,000 visits. Campaign D receives 100 requests from 2,000 visits. These are observed totals, not a controlled test.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rate / nine / effect / five

Analyst: "C converts at ¹ _____ percent."

Lead: "D converts at ² _____ percent."

Analyst: "D has more requests but a lower ³ _____."

Lead: "The totals do not establish a causal ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. nine | 2. five | 3. rate | 4. effect

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected test discussion. Give 6% for A, 7% for B, one percentage point and about 16.7% relative lift using the stated denominators.
2. Switch roles. Keep assignment, stopping rule and analysis checks open; neither a proven winner nor no effect is established.
3. Read the corrected transfer. Contrast C's 90 requests at 9% with D's 100 at 5%, without making a causal claim.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Stopping a scheduled claim before it goes live

A Read the situation

Coordinate a publication hold, preserve review evidence, and communicate only verified status.

A social post scheduled for 3 p.m. says a product is "100% private." The reviewer has requested revised wording and supporting evidence; approval is pending. A paid creator has received the same draft asset, but their publication status is unknown. No privacy incident has been reported in the case. Social lead Noor can pause the company queue, and campaign lead Caleb owns partner coordination. They must prevent unapproved publication, verify the partner's status, and keep a clear record without announcing an incident or clearance that has not been established.

PEOPLE / Noor: Social-media lead | Caleb: Campaign lead

08

USE FIRM OPERATIONAL LANGUAGE WITHOUT INVENTING A CRISIS

A pending review can justify a publication hold without proving a product failure. Name the exact asset and action required. Keep "requested," "confirmed," and "approved" separate so that a message to a partner does not become mistaken evidence that every copy has been stopped.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the company post's current approval state?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Fully approved because it is scheduled | B Rejected as proof of a confirmed privacy incident |
| C Cleared by the paid creator's receipt of the asset | D Pending, with wording and evidence changes requested |

2. What is unknown?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Whether Noor can pause the company queue | B Whether the reviewer requested a revision |
| C Whether the draft says 100% private | D Whether the paid creator has published the draft |

3. Which statement would invent a fact?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Approval remains pending | B The company post is scheduled for 3 p.m. |
| C The partner received the same draft | D A confirmed privacy incident has occurred |

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

publication hold

An instruction or control stopping release pending a condition.

IN USE place a publication hold

approval workflow

The sequence of review and authorization steps for release.

IN USE follow the approval workflow

claims register

A record of claims, evidence, owners, and review status.

IN USE update the claims register

absolute claim

A statement using an unrestricted expression such as always or completely.

IN USE review an absolute claim

material connection

A relationship that may affect how an endorsement is evaluated.

IN USE disclose a material connection

sponsored content

Content produced or distributed as part of a commercial arrangement.

IN USE identify sponsored content

endorsement

A promotional message expressing another party's opinion or experience.

IN USE review an endorsement

disclosure

Information made available to clarify a relevant fact or relationship.

IN USE assess the disclosure

usage rights

Permissions governing how content or an asset may be used.

IN USE verify usage rights

release form

A document recording permission for a specified use or participation.

IN USE check the release form

brand safety

Measures intended to avoid harmful advertising contexts.

IN USE review brand safety

brand suitability

The fit of a placement with a particular brand's standards.

IN USE assess brand suitability

Precision check

Scheduled, approved, and published name different states. Pausing the company queue controls that queue; it does not prove what a partner has done. Record the exact asset, recipient, request, and confirmation rather than saying "everything is stopped" before verification.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

exclusion list

Defined placements or categories barred from a campaign.

IN USE maintain an exclusion list

personal data

Information relating to an identifiable person under the applicable framework.

IN USE protect personal data

data minimization

Limiting collected or shared data to what is needed for the purpose.

IN USE apply data minimization

purpose limitation

Restricting data use to appropriate specified purposes.

IN USE check purpose limitation

retention period

The time for which information is kept under applicable requirements.

IN USE confirm the retention period

access control

Rules limiting who can view or change information.

IN USE enforce access control

incident triage

Initial assessment and routing of a reported event.

IN USE begin incident triage

holding statement

An initial message limited to verified facts while review continues.

IN USE prepare a holding statement

correction notice

A communication identifying and correcting an earlier error.

IN USE issue a correction notice

takedown request

A request to remove published material.

IN USE send a takedown request

escalation path

The designated route for raising an issue to the appropriate authority.

IN USE use the escalation path

audit trail

A traceable record of actions, decisions, and changes.

IN USE preserve the audit trail

Precision check

A disclosure of payment does not establish the truth of a product claim. Likewise, a review concern is not proof of a privacy incident. Keep the commercial relationship, claim evidence, publication status, and incident status as separate questions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE RELEASE STATE

"The asset is scheduled, but approval is still pending."

CHECK THE PARTNER

"Please confirm whether this exact asset has been published."

LIMIT THE ANNOUNCEMENT

"We have a claim-review issue, not a confirmed privacy incident."

CONTROL THE REVISION

"Use only the version approved through the review workflow."

GIVE A PRECISE HOLD

"Pause this version in the company queue now."

PRESERVE THE EVIDENCE

"Keep the draft, reviewer comments, and action history."

SEPARATE DISCLOSURE

"A sponsorship disclosure does not substantiate the product claim."

CLOSE WITH CONFIRMATION

"Record each hold request and the confirmation received."

08

Pause and withdraw

Pause stops a planned release; removing already published material is a different action.

Requested and confirmed

These words distinguish an instruction from evidence that it was carried out.

Same asset

Use an exact version identifier so partners do not act on a different file.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASSIGN COORDINATION

"I will contact the partner and track their response."

SCOPE A RESPONSE

"The statement should include only facts we have checked."

CHECK PERMISSION

"Confirm the agreed usage rights before reusing the creator's asset."

DISTINGUISH REMOVAL

"A takedown request is not confirmation that every copy is gone."

AVOID OVERSTATEMENT

"We have paused our queue; the partner's status remains unverified."

PROTECT PRIVATE DETAILS

"Move personal information into the approved restricted channel."

ESCALATE SPECIFICALLY

"The unresolved claim needs the designated review owner."

RELEASE CAREFULLY

"Resume publication only after the required approvals and version checks."

08

No confirmed incident

This limits what is known without asserting that a review can never find an issue.

Disclosure and proof

A relationship disclosure answers who is connected, not whether the product claim is true.

Only verified facts

This limits a holding statement while investigation or review remains unfinished.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which immediate update is accurate after Noor pauses the queue?

- A** The reviewer has approved the claim because publication was paused.
- B** Our queue is paused; the partner's publication status still needs confirmation.
- C** Every copy on every channel is confirmed removed.
- D** The product has suffered a confirmed privacy incident.

08

2. Which message to the creator resolves the immediate release uncertainty?

- A** Send the creator agreement without checking the draft's publication status.
- B** Hold this exact draft and confirm whether it has already been published.
- C** Replace the headline with another privacy promise and send the new caption.
- D** Confirm the sponsorship disclosure while leaving the asset in the queue.

3. Which statement correctly separates two review issues?

- A** A creator's popularity is the same as supporting evidence.
- B** A publication hold confirms a privacy breach.
- C** Disclosing sponsorship does not prove the product claim.
- D** Sponsorship disclosure makes any product claim acceptable.

4. What belongs in the action record?

- A** A confirmed partner takedown inferred from an unanswered email
- B** Asset version, review comments, hold requests, confirmations, and responsible owners
- C** Only the original schedule, with all review comments deleted
- D** A completed approval status before the reviewer responds

Answers and explanations: page 99.

Stopping a scheduled claim before it goes live

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

absolute claim / usage rights / takedown request / approval workflow / holding statement / publication hold / material connection / data minimization / escalation path / audit trail

08

- 01 **Noor:** The three o'clock post still says one hundred percent private. The reviewer asked for new wording and evidence, but the queue has not been paused.
- 02 **Caleb:** Put this exact version on a ¹ _____ now. A scheduled time is not approval, and we should not let an unchanged draft go live while the review remains open.
- 03 **Noor:** I can pause the company queue. The paid creator received the same draft yesterday, but I cannot tell whether they have already posted it.
- 04 **Caleb:** I will use the partner ² _____ and ask them to hold the asset and confirm its publication status. I will not report their hold as confirmed until they respond.
- 05 **Noor:** Our queue is paused. I saved the draft, but should we delete it now so nobody accidentally picks it up for another channel?
- 06 **Caleb:** Preserve the ³ _____ in the restricted record. We need the draft and reviewer comments to understand what happened, while clearly preventing that version from being used for publication.
- 07 **Noor:** The wording sounds absolute. I do not want to replace it with another broad promise before the reviewer explains which specific product facts can support a claim.
- 08 **Caleb:** Exactly. An ⁴ _____ needs careful review. The team should not invent a softer-looking sentence that still communicates the same unsupported guarantee.
- 09 **Noor:** The creator's draft also needs the commercial relationship made clear. If that disclosure is added, does it settle the issue with the privacy wording?
- 10 **Caleb:** No. A ⁵ _____ is a separate question from the product evidence. Both need appropriate review; completing one does not automatically complete the other.



The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Noor:** Someone suggested a public message apologizing for a privacy incident. We have no reported incident in this case, only the unresolved wording review.
- 12 **Caleb:** Do not announce an invented event. Any ⁶ _____ must stay within verified facts and follow the response process. A publication concern is not itself confirmation of a product failure.
- 13 **Noor:** If the creator replies that the post is already public, we will need a different action from pausing a scheduled post.
- 14 **Caleb:** Then coordinate the appropriate ⁷ _____ and correction review. Record what was requested and confirmed without claiming that one email has removed every possible copy.
- 15 **Noor:** Their contract also covers how we can use their photographs. We should not improvise a replacement advertisement with those images while this is being resolved.
- 16 **Caleb:** Check the ⁸ _____ before any reuse. A file being in our shared folder does not tell us every channel, format, or duration allowed by the agreement.
- 17 **Noor:** I will keep partner contact details and any private review information out of the public response draft. The response team can use the protected record.
- 18 **Caleb:** That follows ⁹ _____ for the communication. Include what the audience needs to know, not private details simply because they appear in the internal discussion.
- 19 **Noor:** I can confirm our post is paused. Please send me the creator's reply when it comes; I cannot report their post as stopped yet.
- 20 **Caleb:** I will track the response and the revised asset through the ¹⁰ _____. Publication resumes only when the required review and version checks are complete, not merely because the scheduled time has passed.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. publication hold | 2. escalation path | 3. audit trail | 4. absolute claim | 5. material connection | 6. holding statement | 7. takedown request | 8. usage rights | 9. data minimization | 10. approval workflow

A complaint is not yet a confirmed cause

F Say it

A customer publicly reports that an order arrived late and includes their address. The cause has not been checked. The support team has an approved private channel and owns the investigation.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

status / cause / channel / delay

Marketer: "Acknowledge the reported ¹ _____."

Support: "Move address details to the approved private ² _____."

Marketer: "Do not announce an unverified ³ _____."

Support: "Record our ownership and the investigation ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. delay | 2. channel | 3. cause | 4. status

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected publication hold. Separate the company queue that Noor can pause from the creator's unverified publication status.
2. Switch roles. Stress the exact draft, partner confirmation, pending claim review and absence of a reported privacy incident.
3. Read the corrected transfer twice. Acknowledge the reported delay and route address details privately without announcing an unverified cause.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A global slogan that does not travel

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain a localization problem and negotiate a usable creative brief.

A software campaign uses the slogan "Hit the ground running." The regional team says a literal translation sounds physical rather than helpful. The launch date is fixed, but the headline is not. No regional performance results exist yet.

PEOPLE / Nadia: Regional marketing lead | Jon: Global creative director

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

localized asset / tone of voice / transcreation / character limit / back-translation / cultural references

- 01 **Jon:** Your team rejected the headline. Is the problem the translation, or do you want a different campaign altogether?
- 02 **Nadia:** The promise works. The idiom does not. We need ¹ _____, not a word-for-word version of an English sporting image.
- 03 **Jon:** What would stay consistent? I need a recognizable campaign across the launch markets, not six unrelated propositions.
- 04 **Nadia:** Keep the first-day setup benefit and product name. Let us change the headline and the example beneath it.
- 05 **Jon:** The example currently mentions an American holiday weekend. I suppose that will need attention too.
- 06 **Nadia:** Yes. I will flag those ² _____ in the brief, with an explanation of the intended effect.
- 07 **Jon:** Can you give the regional writer a direction without prescribing the final line?
- 08 **Nadia:** Something like "Start your first project with a clear plan." That is a direction, not our proposed final headline.
- 09 **Jon:** It sounds less playful than the original. Are we abandoning the brand's personality?
- 10 **Nadia:** No. The ³ _____ can remain warm and confident without using an unfamiliar metaphor.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Jon:** Send two options. Will I receive English versions so I can understand what changed?
- 12 **Nadia:** Yes, with a ⁴ _____ and a note explaining the nuance each English rendering loses.
- 13 **Jon:** That should help. I do not want to approve a smooth English explanation that conceals an awkward regional line.
- 14 **Nadia:** A native-speaking reviewer will check the actual copy. Your review can focus on whether the benefit and boundaries are intact.
- 15 **Jon:** The design has room for forty characters in that slot. Please make that constraint visible before writing starts.
- 16 **Nadia:** I will include the ⁵ _____, along with screenshots of the narrow mobile version.
- 17 **Jon:** Do you expect this adaptation to improve conversion? The launch team will ask why we changed a tested global line.
- 18 **Nadia:** We expect clearer meaning. We have no regional results yet, so I will not attach a conversion claim to it.
- 19 **Jon:** All right. Send the options tomorrow morning. I will review the proposition while your team checks the naturalness.
- 20 **Nadia:** Then we will record the chosen ⁶ _____ and its reviewer in the launch folder.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. transcreation | 2. cultural references | 3. tone of voice | 4. back-translation | 5. character limit | 6. localized asset



A price example in the wrong currency

F Say it in a new situation

A Canadian campaign uses a US-dollar price example. The approved benefit is unchanged, but local pricing has not been supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

localization / owner / offer / confirmed

09

Regional lead: The benefit can stay, but the price needs ¹ _____.

Creative lead: Do not turn a currency conversion into an approved
² _____.

Regional lead: I will request the actual local price from the pricing
³ _____.

Creative lead: Keep the pricing line out of the final asset until that detail is
⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. localization | 2. offer | 3. owner | 4. confirmed

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

The agency delivered impressions, but not the agreed placements

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Distinguish delivery volume from inventory quality and negotiate a remedy.

An agency booked 500,000 impressions on an agreed publisher list. Its report shows 520,000, including 80,000 outside that list. The client has not accepted a remedy. The contract and placement report are available for review.

PEOPLE / Leah: Media manager | Marco: Agency account director

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

flight dates / viewability / makegood / credit note / inventory / insertion order

- 01 **Leah:** Your summary says we overdelivered. The placement breakdown shows eighty thousand impressions on publishers outside the agreed list.
- 02 **Marco:** I see them. The total is higher than the booking, but that does not settle whether we met the ¹ _____.
- 03 **Leah:** Exactly. We bought particular placements. How many impressions can you reconcile to the approved publishers?
- 04 **Marco:** Four hundred forty thousand, assuming the current report is complete. I will check the raw delivery records before treating that as final.
- 05 **Leah:** That would leave sixty thousand against the five-hundred-thousand booking. Please do not offset them with the excluded inventory.
- 06 **Marco:** Understood. I will separate approved ² _____ from the off-list placements in the revised report.
- 07 **Leah:** How did those publishers enter the campaign? The list was attached to the booking.
- 08 **Marco:** The buying team needs to trace that. I will not guess at a platform error before we inspect the settings and change history.
- 09 **Leah:** We also requested a viewability report. An impression appearing in a delivery count does not tell us whether it was viewable.
- 10 **Marco:** I will supply the ³ _____ figures with their measurement basis, separately from the publisher-list reconciliation.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Leah:** Thank you. I want those two questions kept separate in the client update.
- 12 **Marco:** For the shortfall, would you consider a ⁴ _____ on the approved publishers, subject to availability and your acceptance?
- 13 **Leah:** Possibly, but the promotion ends Friday. Extra impressions next month may have little value to us.
- 14 **Marco:** Then timing has to be part of the remedy. I can price the available replacement placements and discuss a credit internally.
- 15 **Leah:** Do not book anything yet. Send both options with dates and any change in format.
- 16 **Marco:** I will make the proposed ⁵ _____ explicit so the replacement cannot drift beyond the promotion unnoticed.
- 17 **Leah:** And show whether accepting an option would resolve the entire dispute or only the delivery shortfall.
- 18 **Marco:** Yes. Any ⁶ _____ will follow the agreed commercial resolution, not an assumption in this call.
- 19 **Leah:** Please send the corrected delivery table first. I need something reliable for this afternoon's review.
- 20 **Marco:** You will have it by two, with any unresolved reconciliation clearly marked and no new placements booked.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. insertion order | 2. inventory | 3. viewability | 4. makegood | 5. flight dates | 6. credit note

An event campaign ends before the replacement run

F Say it in a new situation

A campaign is 20,000 impressions short. The agency offers replacement delivery after the advertised event has finished. The client has not agreed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

remedy / problem / agree / refund

10

Client: Extra impressions after the event do not solve our timing

¹ _____.

Agency: I will label the replacement as a proposal, not an accepted

² _____.

Client: Check the booking terms before promising an automatic

³ _____.

Agency: We will document the resolution once both sides ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. problem | 2. remedy | 3. refund | 4. agree

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

The landing page works with a mouse, but not a keyboard

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Give specific accessibility feedback and coordinate a practical release check.

A landing-page review finds an image-only offer, an unlabeled icon link, and a signup form whose keyboard focus disappears. The campaign designer and web producer must assign fixes. This is a focused review, not certification of the entire website.

PEOPLE / Dev: Campaign designer | Renee: Web producer

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

functional image / text alternative / error message / contrast check / accessible name / focus indicator

11

- 01 **Dev:** The desktop preview looks good. You left three accessibility comments. Which one blocks the signup journey?
- 02 **Renee:** The ¹ _____ disappears at the form. I cannot tell which field I am entering without using the mouse.
- 03 **Dev:** I changed the field styling yesterday. I may have removed the outline with the default border.
- 04 **Renee:** Please restore a visible state and test it through the whole form. The problem is not just the first field.
- 05 **Dev:** What about the offer image? Its text is already visible in the artwork.
- 06 **Renee:** We need an appropriate ² _____. Better still, put the offer in real page text where people can resize and access it.
- 07 **Dev:** I can keep the illustration and move the offer outside it. Does the illustration still need a full description?
- 08 **Renee:** That depends on its purpose. If it adds no information beyond the nearby text, treat it as decorative rather than repeating everything.
- 09 **Dev:** The small arrow beside the offer links to the terms. I called it "blue arrow" in the image description.
- 10 **Renee:** For that ³ _____, describe the destination. "Offer terms" is useful; the arrow's color does not explain the link.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Dev:** Understood. I will also put visible wording beside it so the destination is not a guessing game.
- 12 **Renee:** Good. The button and helper text need a ⁴ _____ after your new colors are applied.
- 13 **Dev:** Could we approve this from the automated report if all three warnings disappear?
- 14 **Renee:** No. Run the report, then test the journey manually. A clean scan does not establish that every interaction is accessible.
- 15 **Dev:** I will test keyboard navigation. Can you check the labels with the team's screen-reader setup?
- 16 **Renee:** Yes, including the ⁵ _____ after an invalid email address. A red border alone is not enough.
- 17 **Dev:** I will give you a test link with the form connected to our test list, not the live campaign list.
- 18 **Renee:** Thanks. We can verify the ⁶ _____ of each control and the confirmation state after submission.
- 19 **Dev:** I will fix the layout and focus styles this morning. Please keep the review comments open until you recheck them.
- 20 **Renee:** Agreed. We will record exactly what passed, without labeling this limited check a full-site accessibility certification.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. focus indicator | 2. text alternative | 3. functional image | 4. contrast check | 5. error message | 6. accessible name

A decorative photo beside complete text

F Say it in a new situation

An article includes a decorative office photo. The offer and all instructions are already in readable page text. A separate icon is the only link to the booking page.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

empty / destination / complete / function

Designer: The office photo adds no new information; its alternative can be
1 _____.

Producer: The booking icon is different because it has a 2 _____.

Designer: Its accessible label should identify the booking 3 _____.

Producer: Test that link using a keyboard before calling the change
4 _____.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. empty | 2. function | 3. destination | 4. complete

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Who was actually interviewed?

A. Six operations coordinators at small agencies

The briefing identifies a small exploratory user sample and explicitly excludes completed buyer research.

2. What does the proposed campaign ask people to do?

A. Book a workflow demonstration

The campaign action is a demonstration request, not a completed purchasing decision.

3. Which conclusion exceeds the evidence?

A. The interviews prove market-wide demand

Six exploratory interviews cannot establish the prevalence of a need across the whole market.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which revision preserves the research correctly?

C. Six interviewed coordinators described repeated calendar checking.

The supported statement retains the participants, observed problem, and limited scope.

2. Which question distinguishes use from purchasing authority?

A. Who uses the tool, and who controls the purchasing budget?

Daily use and budget authority can belong to different roles. Problem frequency, demonstration preferences and channel reach do not establish who can authorize a purchase.

3. Which label fits the immediate campaign action?

C. A booked workflow demonstration

The stated request is to book a demonstration, not complete the later stages.

4. Which response challenges the overclaim constructively?

B. Keep the insight, narrow its scope, and label the buyer assumption for research.

This response preserves useful evidence while correcting the unsupported generalization and missing buyer knowledge.

01 Conversation answers

Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. target audience.** Turn 2. The target audience specifies whom this campaign addresses; it is narrower than everyone working in an office.
- 2. end user.** Turn 4. The end user performs the workflow; using software does not establish control over its purchasing budget.
- 3. demand signal.** Turn 6. The interviews indicate a possible need but do not establish its prevalence throughout the wider market.
- 4. pain point.** Turn 8. The pain point is the specific repeated calendar-checking problem, not an unsupported claim about every scheduling task.
- 5. conversion action.** Turn 10. The conversion action is the defined response counted by this campaign; it is not automatically a sale.
- 6. buyer persona.** Turn 12. The buyer persona should be grounded in purchasing-role research, which this case says has not yet been completed.
- 7. market segment.** Turn 14. The segment defines the campaign's first focus; choosing it does not exclude all future expansion.
- 8. value proposition.** Turn 16. The value proposition connects a relevant benefit to the audience; it must not import an unverified numerical claim.
- 9. leading indicator.** Turn 18. A leading indicator may precede a later outcome; it does not establish that the later outcome occurred.
- 10. research hypothesis.** Turn 20. A research hypothesis identifies a proposition to test rather than presenting it as an established customer fact.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. users

Strategist: "Employees are the daily users."

The supplied facts identify employees as the people using the learning product.

2. decision

Marketer: "The learning director controls the purchasing decision."

The director approves the purchase, which differs from employees trying a lesson.

3. action

Strategist: "Trying a sample is the campaign's immediate action."

The invitation asks for a sample trial rather than a completed company purchase.

4. contract

Marketer: "We must not report that trial as a signed contract."

No company contract has been signed, so the early behavior cannot be reported as one.

02 Briefing and language checks

Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What was the actual comparator?

D. The previous version of the same product

The briefing describes a version-to-version internal task test with no competitor comparison.

2. What time reduction does the supplied test show?

B. 10 seconds, or 20% of the previous 50 seconds

The reduction is 50 minus 40 seconds; dividing 10 by the original 50 gives 20%.

3. Which statement is unsupported?

B. The product is the fastest on the market

A market-wide superlative cannot be established by a test against only the product's earlier version.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which claim most closely matches the supplied measurement?

B. The defined task took 20% less time than in the previous version under the test conditions.

The supported comparison retains the measured task, time basis, earlier version, and conditions.

2. Which sentence uses by and to accurately?

C. Task time fell by 10 seconds to 40 seconds.

The measured values are 50 seconds originally and 40 seconds afterward, a difference of 10.

3. What does the proposed revised wording still require?

C. Review of the complete advertisement and supporting evidence

Arithmetic, a comparator note and creative agreement do not by themselves establish the overall message or approval. The full advertisement must be assessed with its evidence.

4. Which feedback is most useful?

C. Preserve the benefit, but narrow the comparator and task scope.

The useful revision retains a meaningful tested improvement without expanding or mislabeling the evidence.

02 Conversation answers

02

Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. comparator.** Turn 2. The comparator was the previous version; no competing products were included in the stated test.
- 2. benchmark.** Turn 4. The benchmark is the defined task comparison with recorded times, not evidence of a market-wide ranking.
- 3. claim scope.** Turn 6. Claim scope defines what the statement covers; a single task test cannot establish all customer time savings.
- 4. supporting copy.** Turn 8. Supporting copy develops the headline, but its task-time explanation must remain consistent with the main message.
- 5. net impression.** Turn 10. The overall impression may still imply market superiority even when a small note names a narrower comparison.
- 6. brand voice.** Turn 12. Brand voice concerns how the brand speaks; it does not justify adding an unsupported factual ranking.
- 7. proof point.** Turn 14. The proof point is the bounded recorded improvement, not a prediction of every user's experience.
- 8. substantiation.** Turn 16. Substantiation supports the factual claim; an internal wording review does not transform an internal test into independent validation.
- 9. qualifier.** Turn 18. A qualifier preserves the task, comparator, or conditions that limit what the evidence supports.
- 10. approval status.** Turn 20. Approval status distinguishes a proposed revision from a version authorized for publication after the complete review.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. seventy-five

Researcher: "Sixty out of eighty is seventy-five percent."

Dividing 60 by 80 gives 0.75, or 75 percent of the stated participants.

2. comparator

Marketer: "The comparator was our old design."

The test compared the two internal designs, not any competing brand.

3. sample

Researcher: "Keep the participant sample attached to the result."

The limited, unverified sample cannot be silently expanded into a market-wide preference.

4. leadership

Marketer: "We cannot call this proof of market leadership."

No competitor comparison or representative market ranking was established by the supplied test.

03 Briefing and language checks

Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Who owns the shared brief?

A. Priya, the campaign manager

The briefing explicitly assigns ownership of the shared campaign brief to Priya.

2. Which work has actually been prepared?

A. A layout containing placeholder copy

Ben has a layout with temporary wording; the other deliverables are not established as complete.

3. How should Monday be described?

B. A target date subject to unresolved release conditions

The audience, message, and measurement dependencies remain unresolved, so release is not yet authorized.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which update correctly describes the design state?

B. A layout exists, but it still contains placeholder copy.

The supplied work is a draft layout, not an approved or published set of assets.

2. Which sequence fits the dependencies?

C. Complete the brief, finalize creative, check requirements, then authorize release.

The audience and approved message are inputs to final creative, and checks precede release authorization.

3. Who owns message approval under this brief?

C. The product lead

The briefing assigns message approval to the product lead. Coordinating the brief, producing a layout and checking tracking are separate responsibilities.

4. Which statement keeps Monday accurate?

D. Monday is our target; unresolved release conditions still need closure.

A target remains possible without becoming a guarantee or an already authorized release.

03 Conversation answers

Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. campaign brief.** Turn 2. The brief supplies audience, objective, message, and delivery context that a channel calendar alone does not provide.
- 2. dependency.** Turn 4. Final design depends on the approved message because wording changes can alter layout and require further review.
- 3. asset specification.** Turn 6. Asset specifications cover format requirements that can be checked before final wording is supplied.
- 4. workback schedule.** Turn 8. A workback schedule identifies the tasks and review time needed before the target rather than treating the date as evidence of readiness.
- 5. tracking plan.** Turn 10. The tracking plan defines what will be recorded; it must match the agreed campaign action rather than merely count page visits.
- 6. sign-off.** Turn 12. Sign-off must identify the approved content; otherwise a later or different draft may be mistaken for the accepted version.
- 7. single source of truth.** Turn 14. An agreed authoritative record reduces ambiguity about which brief, decision, and asset version is current.
- 8. change request.** Turn 16. A change request makes the new requirement and its effect on work, review, and timing explicit.
- 9. go/no-go decision.** Turn 18. The go/no-go decision authorizes or stops release after reviewing readiness; it is separate from the target date.
- 10. handoff.** Turn 20. The handoff transfers the correct asset and context to the next owner after the required inputs and reviews are complete.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. change

Manager: "The new offer is a proposed change."

The supplied facts distinguish the proposed revision from the currently approved offer.

2. assets

Designer: "It affects all three campaign assets."

Each named asset contains the old offer and would need coordinated revision.

3. approval

Manager: "We need the relevant approval before release."

The new offer is not approved, so a proposal cannot be treated as release authorization.

4. consistent

Designer: "I will then check that every version is consistent."

Coordinated revision must ensure the email, page, and post communicate the same approved offer.

04 Briefing and language checks

Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What task does the query indicate?

A. Learning how to create a meeting agenda

The query asks for instructions, which matches the practical guide promised by the title.

2. Which required elements are missing?

C. An agenda example and a usable sequence

The briefing explicitly requires the example and sequence, neither of which appears in the draft.

3. Which outcome cannot currently be promised?

D. A ranking improvement or traffic increase

The case supplies an editorial problem, not evidence of a future search-performance result.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which feedback most directly resolves the stated problem?

B. Add the required sequence and worked agenda before refining promotional copy.

The missing instructional content is the core gap between the brief, title, and draft.

2. Which sentence correctly limits the search claim?

A. Better task alignment does not guarantee a ranking increase.

Content fit, technical eligibility, and actual search performance are distinct questions.

3. Which use of the feature summary best fits the brief?

D. Move the general announcement elsewhere and retain only task-relevant references.

Useful promotional material can be repurposed without displacing the promised instructional content.

4. Which check most directly verifies that the guide delivers its promised instruction?

A. Confirm the agenda example follows the steps and can be used without purchase

The brief requires usable instruction and a worked example. Search demand, brand presentation and link counts do not establish that a reader can complete the task.

04 Conversation answers

Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. search intent. Turn 2. The query asks for practical instructions; this intended task differs from interest in a product announcement.

2. content gap. Turn 4. The absent sequence and example prevent the draft from meeting the explicitly stated instructional requirement.

3. outline. Turn 6. The outline establishes the sequence of sections before the writer refines individual sentences or promotional details.

4. worked example. Turn 8. A worked example demonstrates the completed output of the instructions, rather than merely naming the product's features.

5. lead paragraph. Turn 10. The lead paragraph sets the article's direction; opening with the reader's task aligns it with the guide's promise.

6. anchor text. Turn 12. Anchor text is the visible linked wording; describing the destination helps readers understand the link's relevance.

7. search volume. Turn 14. Search volume estimates how often a query is used; it does not forecast visits to this specific article.

8. title tag. Turn 16. The title tag identifies the page to systems and displays; it should fit the actual instructional content.

9. crawlability. Turn 18. Crawlability concerns a crawler's access to the page, not the quality of the article or a guaranteed search position.

10. editorial review. Turn 20. Editorial review checks the substance and publication readiness; a revised draft is not automatically a finished or approved guide.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. comparison

Editor: "The title promises a comparison."

A two-plan comparison requires information about both plans rather than one promotional description.

2. both

Writer: "I need the relevant terms for both plans."

The supplied task covers two plans, so omitting either prevents a meaningful comparison.

3. documents

Editor: "Use the current plan documents for factual details."

The current documents are the supplied factual basis, not invented benefits or assumed terms.

4. choice

Writer: "I will not present one plan as the reader's completed choice."

No plan has been selected for the reader, so the page should not claim an existing decision.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

A Briefing checks / page 40

05

1. What is the reported cost per attributed order in week two?

A. \$20

Dividing the stated \$2,400 media spend by 120 attributed orders gives \$20 per order.

2. Which two factors changed together?

A. Creative and the storewide discount

The briefing states that new creative and a 20% discount began on the same day.

3. What prevents the slide's causal conclusion?

A. The before-and-after data do not isolate creative from the concurrent discount.

Both changes occurred together without a control group, so the creative's separate causal effect is not established.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which headline matches the evidence?

C. Attributed orders rose 50% while creative and the discount changed together.

Orders increased by 40 from an 80-order base, but simultaneous changes prevent isolating creative's causal effect.

2. Which metric can be calculated from the supplied data?

C. Media cost per attributed order

The case provides media spend and attributed orders, but not the other required inputs or causal estimate.

3. What does unchanged attribution establish?

C. The stated credit method stayed consistent, not that creative caused the increase.

A stable reporting method supports comparison but does not remove the concurrent intervention or identify customer type.

4. Which revision avoids overstating the result?

D. Replace caused with accompanied and disclose the concurrent promotion.

The revision preserves the observation while making the competing explanation visible instead of changing the metric's meaning.

05 Conversation answers

Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. attribution. Turn 2. Attribution assigns reporting credit; the resulting order increase does not itself establish what caused it.

2. cost per acquisition. Turn 4. Here the defined acquisition action is an attributed order and the stated cost scope is media spend only.

3. blended acquisition cost. Turn 6. A combined acquisition-cost measure requires its own included costs, channels, and acquisition denominator, which are not supplied here.

4. attribution model. Turn 8. Keeping the credit-assignment method unchanged supports reporting consistency but does not separate simultaneous causal influences.

5. confounder. Turn 10. The concurrent discount complicates attributing the change to creative alone, because both interventions could affect orders.

6. incrementality. Turn 12. Incrementality concerns outcomes added by the intervention relative to what would have occurred without it.

7. holdout group. Turn 14. A holdout provides a comparison, but its design and comparability must support the intended causal question.

8. return on ad spend. Turn 16. Return on ad spend needs an appropriate revenue numerator; order counts and spend alone cannot determine it.

9. conversion lag. Turn 18. Conversion lag can make an early reporting period incomplete relative to a more mature comparison period.

10. baseline. Turn 20. The baseline is the first week's defined comparison level, not an experimental estimate of the no-change outcome.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. order

Analyst: "The sales record contains one order."

Both platform credits refer to the same single sales event in the supplied facts.

2. deduplication

Lead: "Combining platform counts requires deduplication."

Adding both credits without removing overlap would count one order twice.

3. attribution

Analyst: "Credit assignment is attribution, not proof of cause."

The platform reports allocate credit under their rules rather than establish a separate causal effect.

4. incrementality

Lead: "Neither report alone establishes incrementality."

Without an appropriate causal comparison, neither platform's additional effect is identified.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. How many contacts have a documented demonstration request?

C. 20

The supplied export separates 20 demonstration requests from 60 guide downloads and 20 unknown-source records.

2. What remains unchecked across the export?

A. Contact permissions and suppression status

The briefing explicitly says permission and suppression checks have not yet been completed.

3. Can all 100 records currently be called sales-ready under the stated procedure?

D. No; the request, source, checks, and ownership conditions are not all met.

The company's supplied criteria require more than contact details, and the case does not impose a blanket ban on responding.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which handoff summary is accurate?

A. Twenty demonstration requests are identified, with required checks still pending.

The summary preserves the known request count and does not invent results for the unfinished checks.

2. Which action preserves record integrity?

A. Retain the original source and mark unverified fields for review.

Source history and uncertainty should remain visible rather than be overwritten to satisfy a target.

3. Which record fits every stated sales-ready condition?

A. A documented request with verified source, completed permission checks and a named owner

The case requires the request, verified origin, permission checks and receiving owner together. Each alternative omits at least one condition or substitutes an engagement signal for a request.

4. Which question resolves a qualification disagreement?

A. Which event and completed checks does this stage require?

Asking for the stage's concrete criteria turns an ambiguous label into a testable operational definition.

06 Conversation answers

Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. CRM. Turn 2. The CRM holds the relationship records, including the different events that produced this export.

2. intent signal. Turn 4. An intent signal can suggest interest without establishing the specific sales-conversation request required by this company's procedure.

3. lead source. Turn 6. The recorded demonstration-request source is one criterion, but permission, suppression, and ownership checks are separate requirements.

4. lifecycle stage. Turn 8. The lifecycle stage must reflect the current process state rather than prematurely label an unchecked record sales-ready.

5. consent record. Turn 10. A consent record needs scope and context; an older permission entry may not answer the current channel or purpose question.

6. suppression list. Turn 12. A suppression list excludes records from specified communication activity; exporting a record does not remove that status.

7. routing rule. Turn 14. A routing rule determines the receiving owner after the record meets the applicable handoff conditions.

8. service-level agreement. Turn 16. The service-level agreement defines responsibilities and response expectations rather than supplying missing qualification evidence.

9. recycle reason. Turn 18. A recycle reason explains why the record returns to an earlier process, making the handoff outcome usable for follow-up.

10. source provenance. Turn 20. Source provenance preserves how each record originated, including the unresolved history of unknown-source contacts.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. address

Operator: "The export contains the same address."

The case identifies one address appearing in both records, not evidence of a new person.

2. preference

Lead: "It does not establish a changed preference."

The later export supplies no new preference information, so the earlier status cannot be assumed reversed.

3. record

Operator: "I will preserve the existing suppression record."

Preserving the current record avoids silently removing a restriction without evidence or review.

4. process

Lead: "Resolve the conflict through the approved process."

The supplied facts call for review rather than treating the export as automatic authorization.

07 Briefing and language checks

Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What are the observed unique clicker rates?

C. A: 6%; B: 7%

The rates are 120 divided by 2,000 and 140 divided by 2,000, respectively.

2. What is the absolute difference between those rates?

D. 1 percentage point

Seven percent minus six percent equals one percentage point; relative change uses a different calculation.

3. Which conclusion is currently unsupported?

A. B is a statistically established and commercially superior winner

The design and statistical checks remain incomplete, and no purchase results establish commercial superiority.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which sentence reports both forms of change accurately?

A. B is one percentage point higher, about 16.7% above A on a relative basis.

The absolute difference is 7% minus 6%; relative lift divides that one-point difference by 6%.

2. Which statement keeps the measured outcome distinct from a business result?

D. B has a higher observed unique-clicker rate; purchase outcomes are not supplied.

The numerator counts unique clickers, not orders, revenue or customers. Equal delivery totals do not supply the missing downstream results.

3. What is a justified next step?

D. Verify design, stopping rule, and statistical analysis before declaring a proven winner.

Neither certainty nor no effect follows from incomplete checks; the case requires completing them.

4. Which readout is appropriately concise?

C. B's observed rate is higher; the statistical and commercial conclusions remain open.

The observed rate can be reported now while its stronger implications remain qualified.

07 Conversation answers

Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. denominator. Turn 2. Each rate divides unique clickers by 2,000 delivered messages; a different denominator would change the metric.

2. percentage point. Turn 4. A percentage point expresses the absolute difference between 7% and 6%, rather than their relative change.

3. relative lift. Turn 6. Relative lift divides the change by A's baseline rate; it does not create a larger absolute difference.

4. randomization. Turn 8. Randomization concerns how units were assigned; equal delivered counts alone do not establish the assignment process.

5. stopping rule. Turn 10. The planned stopping rule matters because outcome-driven early stopping can change how statistical evidence should be interpreted.

6. statistical significance. Turn 12. Statistical significance depends on a specified method and criterion; a positive observed difference alone does not establish it.

7. confidence interval. Turn 14. A confidence interval communicates uncertainty under its method and assumptions; the current briefing supplies no calculated interval.

8. Practical significance. Turn 16. Practical significance concerns decision-relevant magnitude and value; more clicks do not automatically establish more profitable purchases.

9. primary metric. Turn 18. The primary metric is selected for evaluating the experiment; choosing it after seeing favorable results changes the evidential context.

10. executive readout. Turn 20. An executive readout gives the observed finding, its limits, and decision implications without converting incomplete analysis into proof.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. nine

Analyst: "C converts at nine percent."

Dividing 90 requests by 1,000 visits gives 9 percent.

2. five

Lead: "D converts at five percent."

Dividing 100 requests by 2,000 visits gives 5 percent despite the larger request count.

3. rate

Analyst: "D has more requests but a lower rate."

The count and rate move in different directions because D has twice as many visits.

4. effect

Lead: "The totals do not establish a causal effect."

The supplied comparison is observational rather than a controlled design isolating a campaign effect.

08 Briefing and language checks

Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is the company post's current approval state?

D. Pending, with wording and evidence changes requested

The reviewer has requested changes and supporting evidence, so scheduling does not establish approval.

2. What is unknown?

D. Whether the paid creator has published the draft

The briefing specifically leaves the partner's publication status unverified.

3. Which statement would invent a fact?

D. A confirmed privacy incident has occurred

The case explicitly supplies no reported privacy incident, so one must not be announced as established.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which immediate update is accurate after Noor pauses the queue?

B. Our queue is paused; the partner's publication status still needs confirmation.

Pausing one controlled queue establishes only that action, not partner status, incident facts, or claim approval.

2. Which message to the creator resolves the immediate release uncertainty?

B. Hold this exact draft and confirm whether it has already been published.

The unapproved version needs a hold and a publication-status check. Disclosure and contract records answer different questions; replacement wording also needs review.

3. Which statement correctly separates two review issues?

C. Disclosing sponsorship does not prove the product claim.

The commercial relationship and the evidence for the product assertion are distinct questions.

4. What belongs in the action record?

B. Asset version, review comments, hold requests, confirmations, and responsible owners

A traceable record preserves what was requested, what is verified, and who must resolve the remaining work.

08 Conversation answers

Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. publication hold.** Turn 2. A publication hold stops the unapproved release while the requested claim review remains unresolved.
- 2. escalation path.** Turn 4. The escalation path identifies the responsible route for urgent partner coordination; it does not assume the partner has already acted.
- 3. audit trail.** Turn 6. The audit trail records the draft, review concern, and actions; deleting it would remove evidence needed to understand the decision.
- 4. absolute claim.** Turn 8. An absolute claim leaves little or no qualification; substituting another unrestricted promise would not resolve the evidence gap.
- 5. material connection.** Turn 10. A material connection concerns the relationship behind an endorsement; disclosing it does not substantiate the separate product assertion.
- 6. holding statement.** Turn 12. A holding statement should stay within verified facts; an unresolved claim review does not establish a privacy incident.
- 7. takedown request.** Turn 14. A takedown request concerns already published content; sending it is not proof that removal has occurred everywhere.
- 8. usage rights.** Turn 16. Usage rights define permitted uses of the creator's assets; access to a file does not establish unrestricted reuse.
- 9. data minimization.** Turn 18. Data minimization keeps unnecessary personal details out of the public communication while preserving relevant information in the appropriate record.
- 10. approval workflow.** Turn 20. The approval workflow controls review and authorization of the revised version before publication resumes.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. delay

Marketer: "Acknowledge the reported delay."

The customer reported lateness; acknowledging that report does not establish its cause.

2. channel

Support: "Move address details to the approved private channel."

The supplied private route avoids repeating the customer's address in a public exchange.

3. cause

Marketer: "Do not announce an unverified cause."

The briefing says the cause is unchecked, so a public explanation must not invent it.

4. status

Support: "Record our ownership and the investigation status."

The team owns the investigation, and its current status should be reported without implying completion.

08

09 Conversation answers

A global slogan that does not travel

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. transcreation. Turn 2. Transcreation adapts the creative idea and intended effect rather than translating each word literally.

2. cultural references. Turn 6. The holiday is a culturally specific reference that may not carry the same meaning elsewhere.

3. tone of voice. Turn 10. Tone of voice describes how the brand sounds; changing an idiom does not require abandoning that personality.

4. back-translation. Turn 12. A back-translation renders the adapted text back into the original language for review of meaning.

5. character limit. Turn 16. The character limit is the specific layout constraint the writer must receive before producing options.

6. localized asset. Turn 20. The localized asset is the market-specific deliverable, distinct from its explanatory back-translation.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. localization

Regional lead: The benefit can stay, but the price needs localization.

Localization adapts market-specific details such as the currency and applicable price.

2. offer

Creative lead: Do not turn a currency conversion into an approved offer.

An arithmetic conversion does not establish the commercial offer available locally.

3. owner

Regional lead: I will request the actual local price from the pricing owner.

The responsible pricing owner must supply the commercial detail still missing.

4. confirmed

Creative lead: Keep the pricing line out of the final asset until that detail is confirmed.

The price is currently missing, so confirmation must precede its publication.

10 Conversation answers

The agency delivered impressions, but not the agreed placements

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. insertion order. Turn 2. The insertion order records the media booking terms against which the placement delivery must be assessed.

2. inventory. Turn 6. Inventory refers to the advertising placements available or supplied, not simply the total number of impressions.

3. viewability. Turn 10. Viewability is a separate measurement of whether an impression met specified opportunity-to-be-seen criteria.

4. makegood. Turn 12. A makegood is replacement media offered to remedy a delivery problem; it still needs agreement.

5. flight dates. Turn 16. Flight dates specify when the advertising will run, which matters because this promotion ends Friday.

6. credit note. Turn 18. A credit note records an agreed reduction to the amount billed; it is not automatically created by offering replacement media.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. problem

Client: Extra impressions after the event do not solve our timing problem.

The advertised event has ended, so later delivery may not serve the original purpose.

2. remedy

Agency: I will label the replacement as a proposal, not an accepted remedy.

The client has not agreed to the proposed replacement delivery.

3. refund

Client: Check the booking terms before promising an automatic refund.

The supplied facts do not establish an automatic contractual right to a refund.

4. agree

Agency: We will document the resolution once both sides agree.

A resolution must reflect agreement rather than the agency's unilateral proposal.

10

11 Conversation answers

The landing page works with a mouse, but not a keyboard

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

- 1. focus indicator.** Turn 2. The focus indicator shows which interactive element currently receives keyboard input; its disappearance obstructs keyboard navigation.
- 2. text alternative.** Turn 6. A text alternative makes the image's meaningful information available when the image itself cannot be used.
- 3. functional image.** Turn 10. A functional image acts as a control or link, so its alternative should identify the action or destination.
- 4. contrast check.** Turn 12. A contrast check examines whether foreground and background colors provide sufficient visual distinction for their intended use.
- 5. error message.** Turn 16. The error message must communicate a failed input clearly; a border color alone does not explain the problem.
- 6. accessible name.** Turn 18. The accessible name identifies a control to assistive technology and should accurately express its purpose.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. empty

Designer: The office photo adds no new information; its alternative can be empty.

A decorative image can have an empty alternative rather than repeat nearby information.

2. function

Producer: The booking icon is different because it has a function.

The icon operates as a link and is therefore not merely decorative.

3. destination

Designer: Its accessible label should identify the booking destination.

A useful label tells the user where the functional image's link leads.

4. complete

Producer: Test that link using a keyboard before calling the change complete.

Visual appearance alone does not verify that the link is usable by keyboard.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Narrow the decision: For this campaign, which role are we trying to reach first?

Define the action: We want qualified coordinators to book a workflow demonstration.

Close with scope: Let us revise the audience, evidence statement, and conversion action.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Recognize the aim: The line creates energy, but its comparison is broader than the test.

State the calculation: That is a 20% reduction in the measured task time.

Close with review: The complete revised advertisement still needs approval.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Name the gap: The calendar has channels and a date, but the brief is incomplete.

Specify the dependency: Final creative depends on the audience and approved message.

Close with conditions: We need message sign-off and tracking checks before go/no-go.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Name the reader task: The searcher wants to create an agenda, not read a launch announcement.

Request a structure: Start with the steps, then show a completed agenda.

Close with review: We will check the example and title against the revised body.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Lead with the result: Attributed orders rose from 80 to 120 at the same media spend.

Limit causality: This comparison does not isolate the effect of the creative.

Close with accurate wording: Report the increase without assigning all of it to the creative.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Correct the count: Twenty contacts requested demonstrations; the other records have different statuses.

Apply the threshold: Use the stated handoff criteria before marking a record sales-ready.

Close with routing: Route the verified requests through the agreed process.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

State the observation: A recorded 6% and B recorded 7% unique clicker rates.

Limit the verdict: B is higher in this sample; a proven winner is not yet established.

Close with next steps: Finish the design and statistical checks before the stronger claim.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Name the release state: The asset is scheduled, but approval is still pending.

Preserve the evidence: Keep the draft, reviewer comments, and action history.

Close with confirmation: Record each hold request and the confirmation received.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

A/B test plan an A/B test	59
absolute claim review an absolute claim	68
acceptance criterion set acceptance criteria	24
access control enforce access control	69
addressable market define the addressable market	6
anchor text use descriptive anchor text	33
approval status confirm the approval status	15
approval workflow follow the approval workflow	68
approver identify the approver	24
asset specification confirm the asset specification	23
attribution model identify the attribution model	41
attribution window confirm the attribution window	41
audience overlap measure audience overlap	42
audit trail preserve the audit trail	69
barrier to adoption investigate a barrier to adoption	6
baseline document the baseline	42
benchmark document the benchmark	14
benefit statement sharpen the benefit statement	15
bid strategy review the bid strategy	42
blended acquisition cost define blended acquisition cost	42
brand safety review brand safety	68
brand suitability assess brand suitability	68
brand voice preserve the brand voice	15
budget pacing adjust budget pacing	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

buyer persona validate a buyer persona	5
buying committee map the buying committee	5
campaign brief complete the campaign brief	23
campaign objective agree the campaign objective	6
canonical URL specify the canonical URL	33
change request document the change request	24
channel mix agree the channel mix	24
claim scope narrow the claim scope	14
claims register update the claims register	68
click-through rate compare click-through rates	41
cohort compare like-for-like cohorts	60
commercial intent distinguish commercial intent	32
comparative claim qualify a comparative claim	14
comparator identify the comparator	14
confidence interval report a confidence interval	60
confounder identify a possible confounder	42
consent record check the consent record	50
content brief follow the content brief	32
content gap close the content gap	33
contingency agree a launch contingency	24
control variant define the control variant	59
conversion action specify the conversion action	6
conversion lag account for conversion lag	42
copy review complete the copy review	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

correction notice	issue a correction notice	69
cost per acquisition	specify the cost-per-acquisition basis	41
cost per click	calculate cost per click	41
cost per mille	compare cost per mille	41
crawlability	check crawlability	33
creative brief	refine the creative brief	24
creative fatigue	investigate creative fatigue	42
creative territory	explore a creative territory	15
critical path	identify the critical path	23
CRM	update the CRM record	50
customer insight	develop a customer insight	5
data minimization	apply data minimization	69
decision criterion	clarify the decision criteria	6
deduplication	apply conversion deduplication	42
deliverability	monitor deliverability	51
deliverable	define the deliverable	23
demand signal	evaluate a demand signal	6
denominator	verify the denominator	59
dependency	resolve a dependency	23
differentiator	substantiate the differentiator	15
disclosure	assess the disclosure	68
double opt-in	document the double opt-in	51
drop-off	measure stage-to-stage drop-off	60
economic buyer	identify the economic buyer	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

editorial angle refine the editorial angle	32
editorial review complete editorial review	33
end user interview the end user	5
endorsement review an endorsement	68
escalation path use the escalation path	69
exclusion list maintain an exclusion list	69
executive readout prepare the executive readout	60
feature claim verify a feature claim	15
fit score review the fit score	50
frequency monitor ad frequency	41
funnel stage distinguish funnel stages	60
go-to-market plan align the go-to-market plan	23
go/no-go decision hold the go/no-go review	23
guardrail metric monitor a guardrail metric	59
handoff prepare a complete handoff	24
hard bounce suppress a hard bounce	51
headline revise the headline	14
holding statement prepare a holding statement	69
holdout group define the holdout group	42
ideal customer profile refine the ideal customer profile	5
impression count ad impressions	41
incident triage begin incident triage	69
incrementality estimate incrementality	42
indexability investigate indexability	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

informational intent serve informational intent	32
intent signal interpret an intent signal	50
internal link add a relevant internal link	33
jobs to be done frame the job to be done	5
keyword research conduct keyword research	32
last-click attribution interpret last-click attribution	41
launch readiness assess launch readiness	23
lead review a new lead	50
lead paragraph rewrite the lead paragraph	32
lead scoring calibrate lead scoring	50
lead source verify the lead source	50
leading indicator monitor a leading indicator	6
lifecycle stage verify the lifecycle stage	50
market segment prioritize a market segment	5
marketing-qualified lead define a marketing-qualified lead	50
material connection disclose a material connection	68
media booking confirm the media booking	24
message architecture maintain the message architecture	15
message hierarchy build a message hierarchy	14
meta description write a useful meta description	33
metadata review page metadata	33
minimum detectable effect specify the minimum detectable effect	60
multiple testing account for multiple testing	60
net impression review the net impression	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

nurture sequence review the nurture sequence	51
outline revise the outline	32
p-value interpret the p-value	60
pain point substantiate a pain point	5
penetration estimate market penetration	6
percentage point report a percentage-point change	59
personal data protect personal data	69
pixel validate the tracking pixel	42
positioning clarify the positioning	14
practical significance distinguish practical significance	60
preference center update the preference center	51
primary metric specify the primary metric	59
proof point attach a proof point	14
publication hold place a publication hold	68
purchase trigger identify a purchase trigger	6
purpose limitation check purpose limitation	69
qualifier retain the necessary qualifier	15
qualitative research synthesize qualitative research	6
query interpret the query	32
RACI matrix clarify roles in a RACI matrix	24
randomization verify randomization	59
randomization unit choose the randomization unit	59
reach report unique reach	41
reason to believe supply a reason to believe	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

recycle reason document the recycle reason	51
relative lift calculate relative lift	59
release form check the release form	68
research hypothesis state a research hypothesis	6
retention period confirm the retention period	69
return on ad spend qualify return on ad spend	41
routing rule apply the routing rule	51
sales-qualified lead confirm a sales-qualified lead	50
sample bias acknowledge sample bias	6
sample ratio mismatch investigate a sample ratio mismatch	59
sample size determine the sample size	59
scope creep flag scope creep	24
search intent match search intent	32
search volume interpret search volume	32
segmentation rule validate a segmentation rule	51
SERP review the SERP	32
service-level agreement clarify the service-level agreement	51
sign-off obtain message sign-off	23
single source of truth maintain a single source of truth	23
soft bounce investigate a soft bounce	51
source provenance preserve source provenance	50
sponsored content identify sponsored content	68
statistical power assess statistical power	60
statistical significance assess statistical significance	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

stopping rule follow the stopping rule	60
subheading write descriptive subheadings	32
substantiation review claim substantiation	14
superlative challenge an unsupported superlative	14
supporting copy align the supporting copy	14
suppression list apply the suppression list	50
takedown request send a takedown request	69
target audience define the target audience	5
test conditions disclose relevant test conditions	14
thought leadership substantiate thought leadership	33
title tag align the title tag	33
tone adjust the tone	15
tracking plan validate the tracking plan	24
treatment variant describe the treatment variant	59
triggered email test the triggered email	51
unsubscribe process an unsubscribe	51
usage rights verify usage rights	68
use case define the primary use case	5
UTM parameter standardize UTM parameters	24
value proposition sharpen the value proposition	5
version control apply version control	23
view-through conversion separate view-through conversions	41
workback schedule build a workback schedule	23
worked example include a worked example	33

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Google Search Central. Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for matching useful content to an intended audience. The editorial examples and dialogues are original teaching cases. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] Federal Trade Commission. Advertising and Marketing.

[Open the original source](#)

US guidance on truthful advertising, claims, and endorsements. The cases practice recognizing a review issue, not issuing legal clearance. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Federal Trade Commission. CAN-SPAM Act: A Compliance Guide for Business.

[Open the original source](#)

US commercial-email background. Permission records and other jurisdictions require separate review; a contact record alone is not a complete compliance assessment. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] Microsoft Research. Patterns of Trustworthy Experimentation: Pre-Experiment Stage.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on defining a hypothesis, relevant metrics, and experimental design before interpreting results. The book is language practice, not statistical certification. Checked 10 October 2026.

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